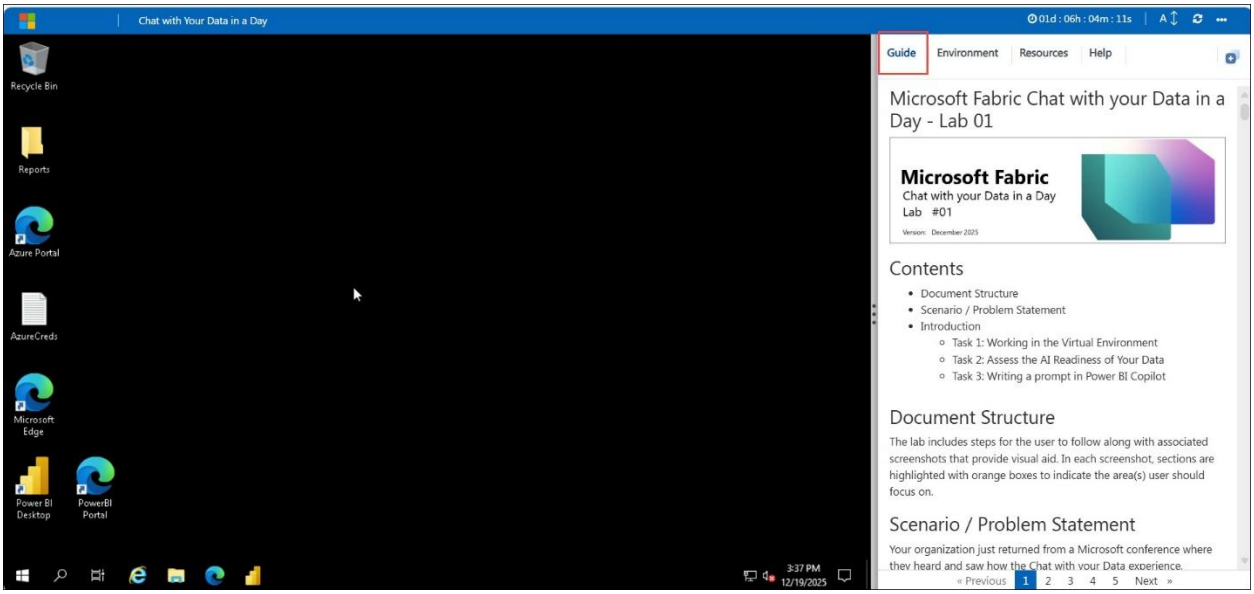
Getting Started with Chat with your Data in a Day

Welcome to your Chat with your Data in a Day workshop! Today, you will learn why preparing data models is critical for an effective *Chat with your Data* experience by exploring how Copilot responds to different user requests. You will also practice validating those responses for accuracy and understand how proper data preparation improves Copilot performance in future labs.

## Accessing Your Lab Environment

Once you're ready to dive in, your virtual machine and lab guide will be right at your fingertips within your web browser.




## Virtual Machine & Lab Guide

Your virtual machine is your workhorse throughout the workshop. The lab guide is your roadmap to success.

## Exploring Your Lab Resources

To get a better understanding of your lab resources and credentials, navigate to the **Environment** tab.

Guide | Environment | Resources | Help

Here are your credentials to login to Microsoft Azure and access the on-demand lab.

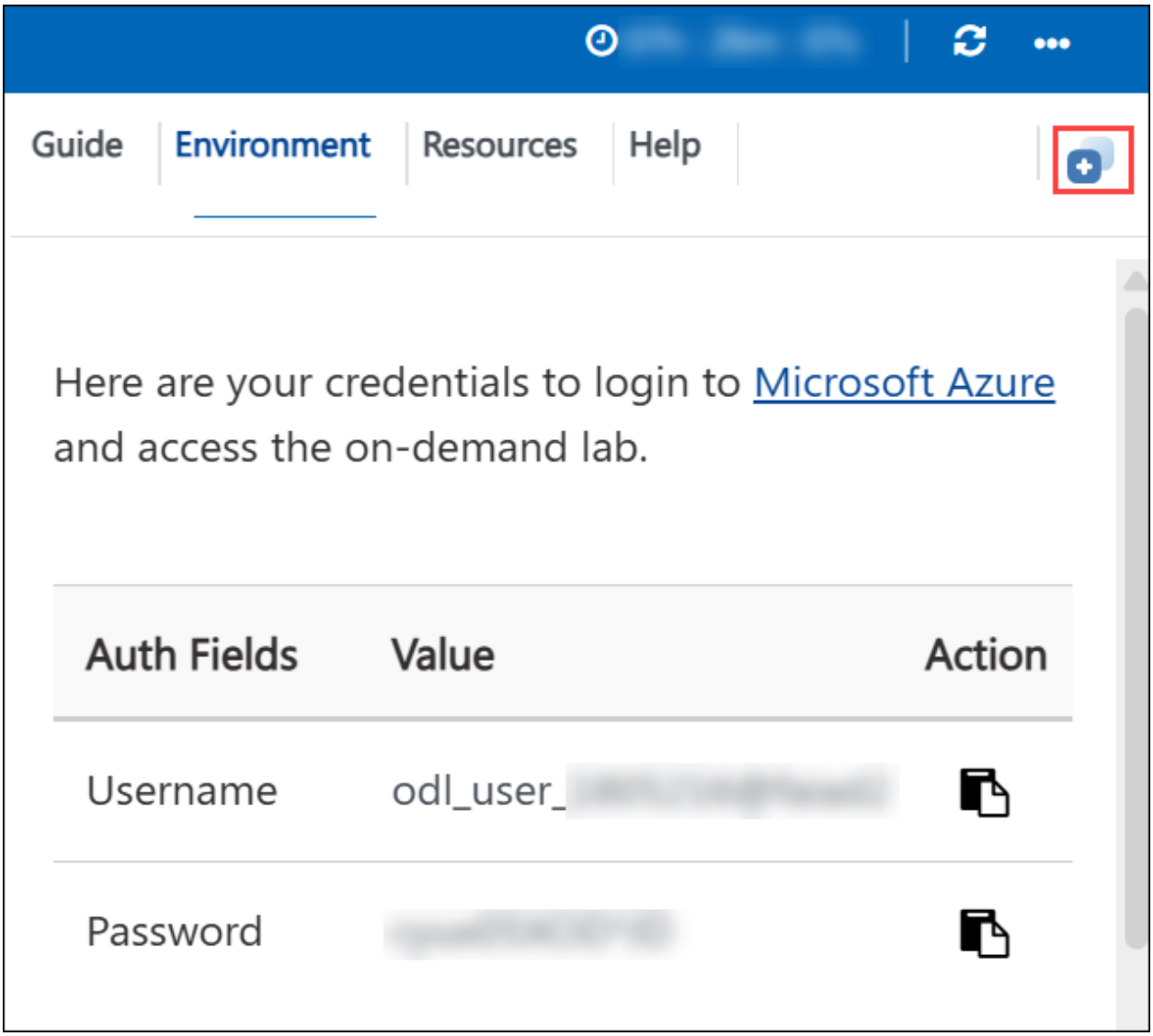
| Auth Fields | Value | Action |
|---|---|---|
| Username | odl_user_ | |
| Password | | |

Resource Group :

| Key | Value | Action |
|---|---|---|
| DeploymentID | | |
| LabVM Admin Username | | |
| LabVM Admin | | |

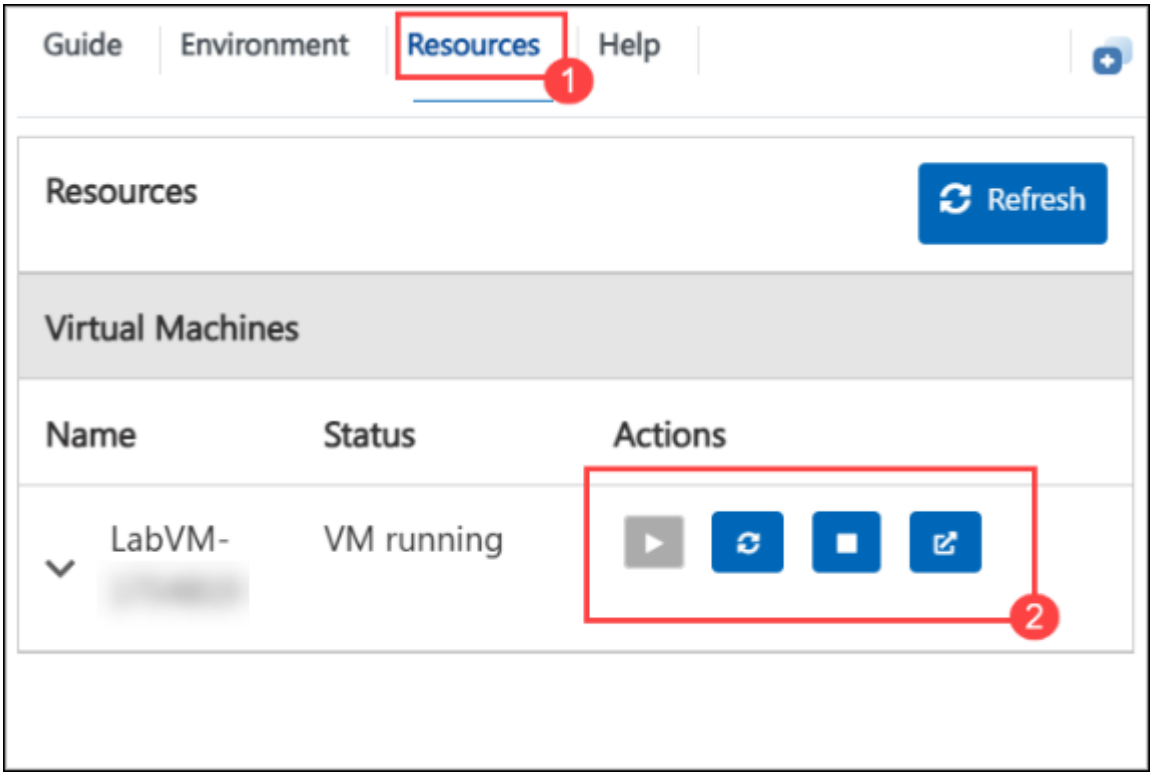
**Utilizing the Split Window Feature**

For convenience, you can open the lab guide in a separate window by selecting the **Split Window** button from the Top right corner.




**Managing Your Virtual Machine**

Feel free to start, stop, or restart your virtual machine as needed from the **Resources** tab. Your experience is in your hands!




Microsoft Fabric Chat with your Data in a Day - Lab 01

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## Document Structure

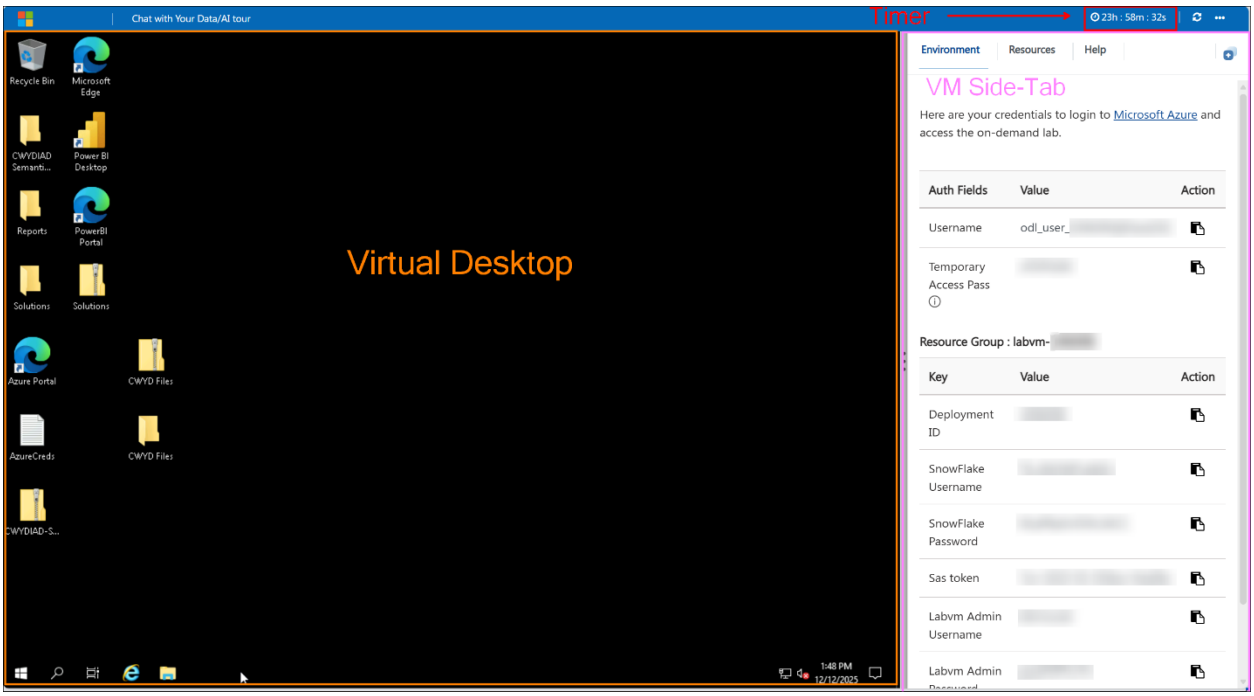
The lab includes steps for the user to follow along with associated screenshots that provide visual aid. In each screenshot, sections are highlighted with orange boxes to indicate the area(s) user should focus on.

Scenario / Problem Statement

Your organization just returned from a Microsoft conference where they heard and saw how the Chat with your Data experience, powered by Copilot can dramatically accelerate time to insights. The demos showcased how natural language queries can unlock powerful analytics, provided the underlying semantic models are well-structured and optimized for AI.

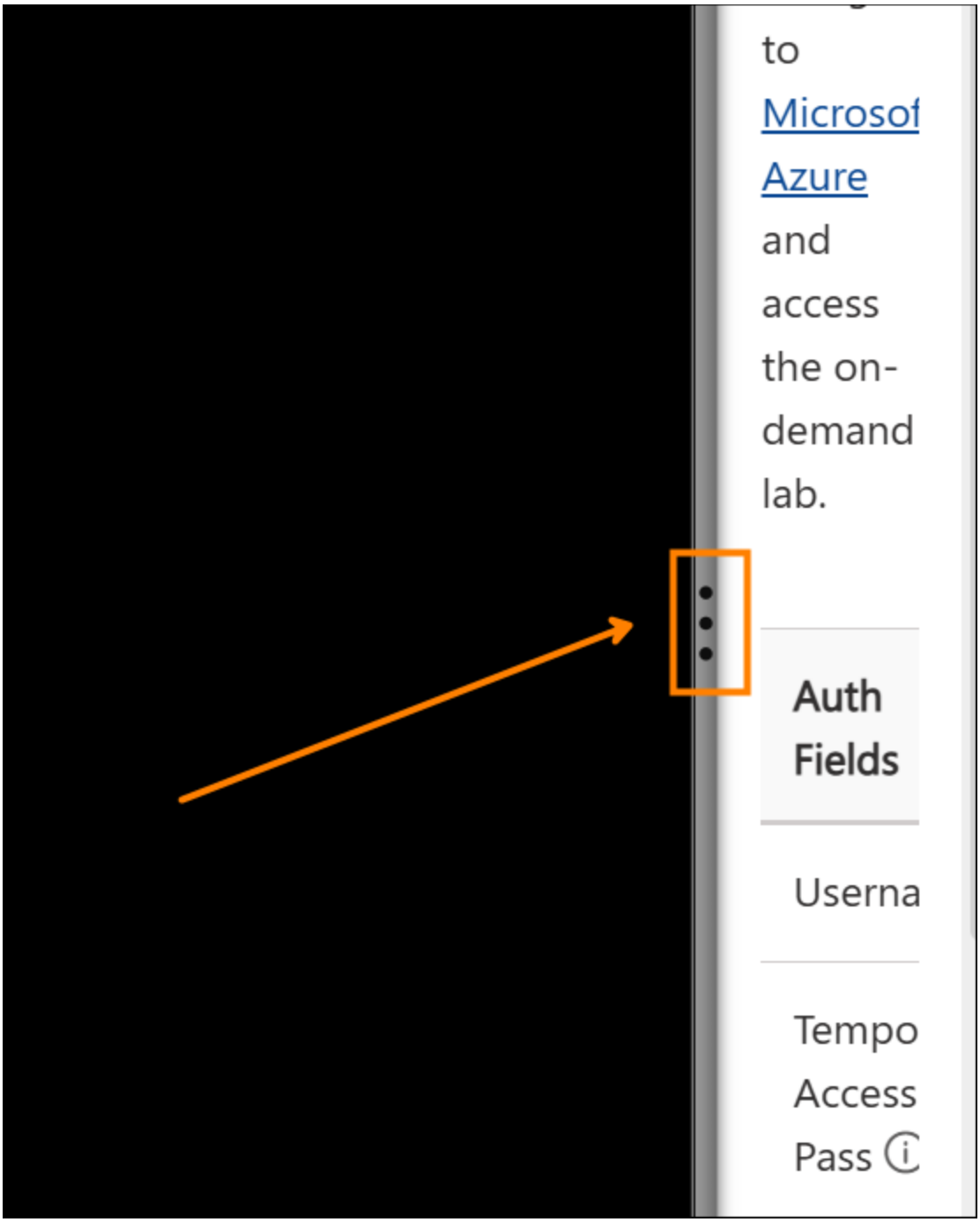
# Task 1: Working in the Virtual Environment

1. The virtual environment experience is phenomenal for providing you with an available space to work with the Chat with Your Data Experience! Let's look at a few key areas and points.




2. Let's look at a few key areas:
    - The virtual desktop acts as a fully-functional computer for you to use in browser!

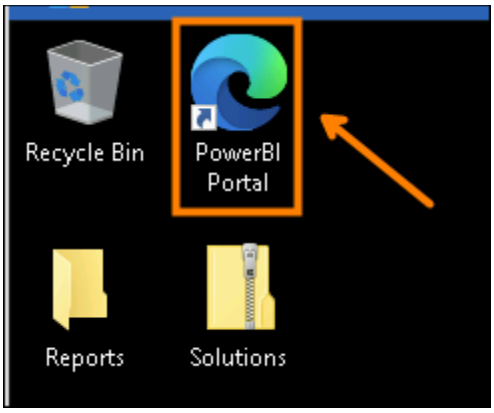
- The VM Side-Tab is where you can access the Lab documents, Credentials, and more.
- The Timer shows how much remaining time you have to use the Virtual Machine.



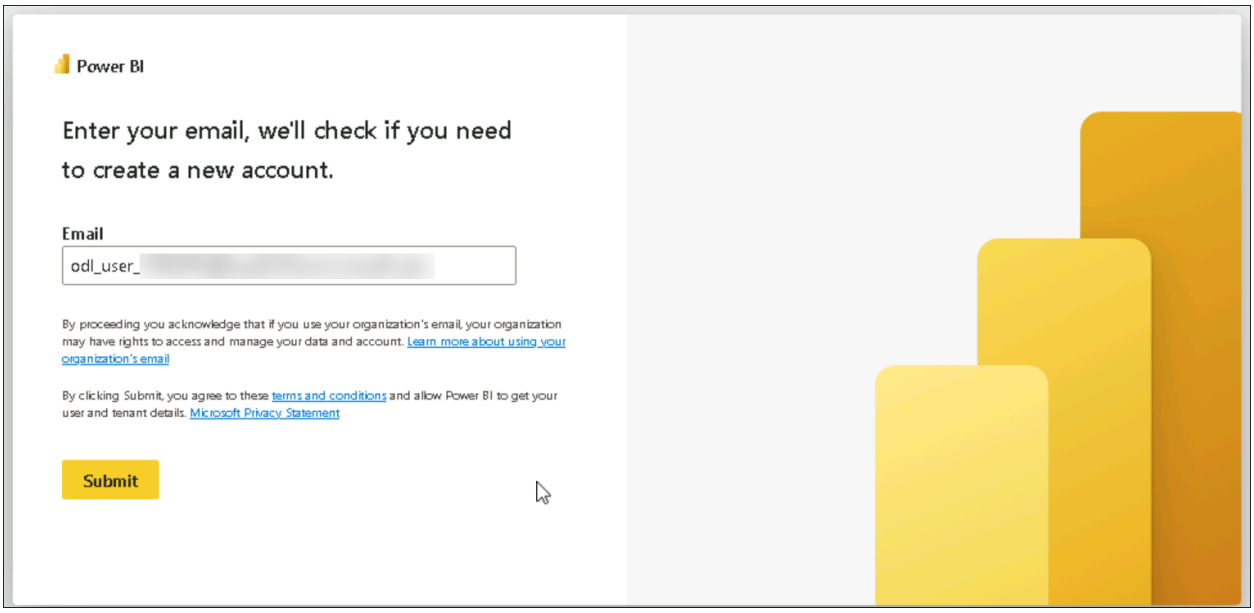
3. In class, you can work fully inside the Virtual Machine. However, some attendees prefer to work with an Incognito Browser and log in to the Power Bi Desktop under the Virtual Machine credentials they are granted. That is perfectly acceptable!

Task 2: Work with Copilot

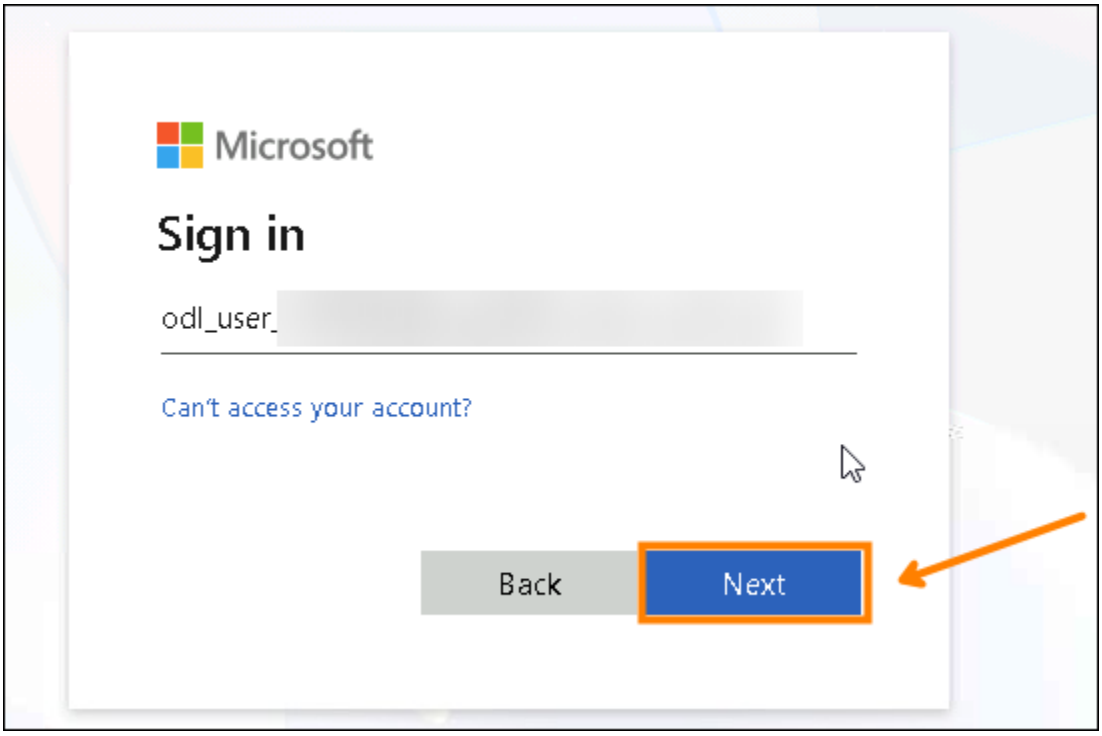
1. Now that you have seen the major areas of the Virtual Machine, proceed to the Power BI Portal button to launch the Power BI Service.



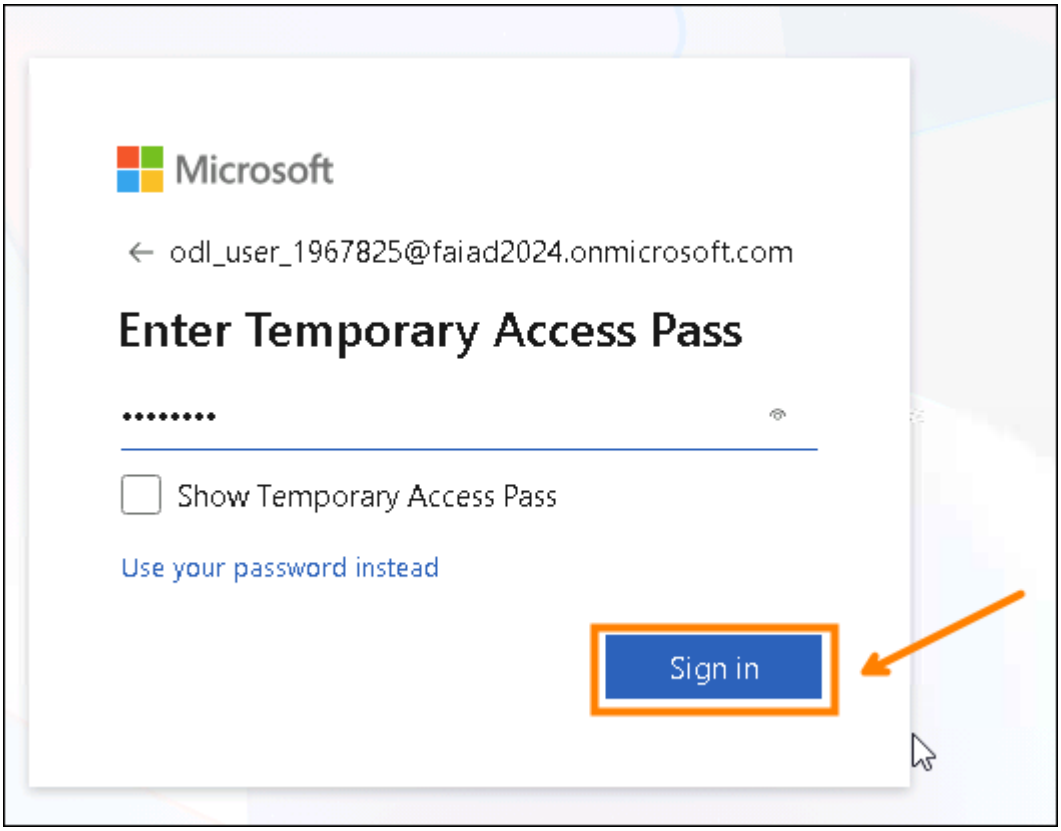

2. Using the credentials listed on the credentials page and in your document provide the email in the Email Access area.
    - **Username/Email: (1)**



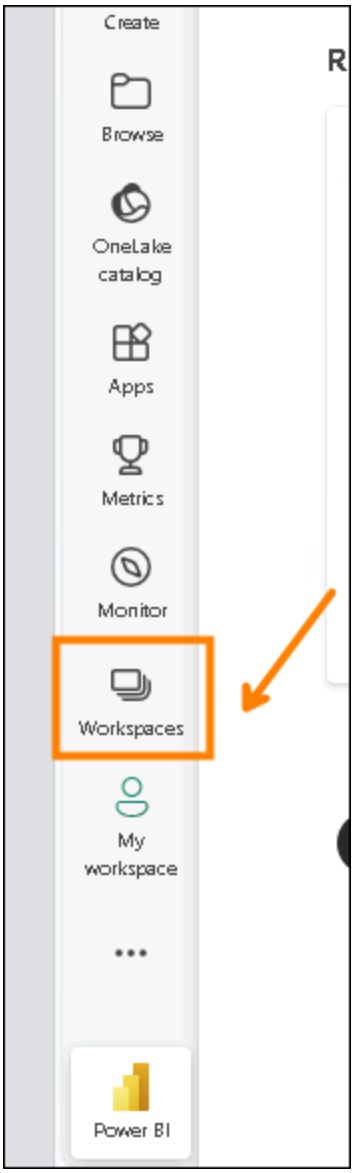

3. Then use the Microsoft **Sign IN** box with the same credentials and click **Next**.



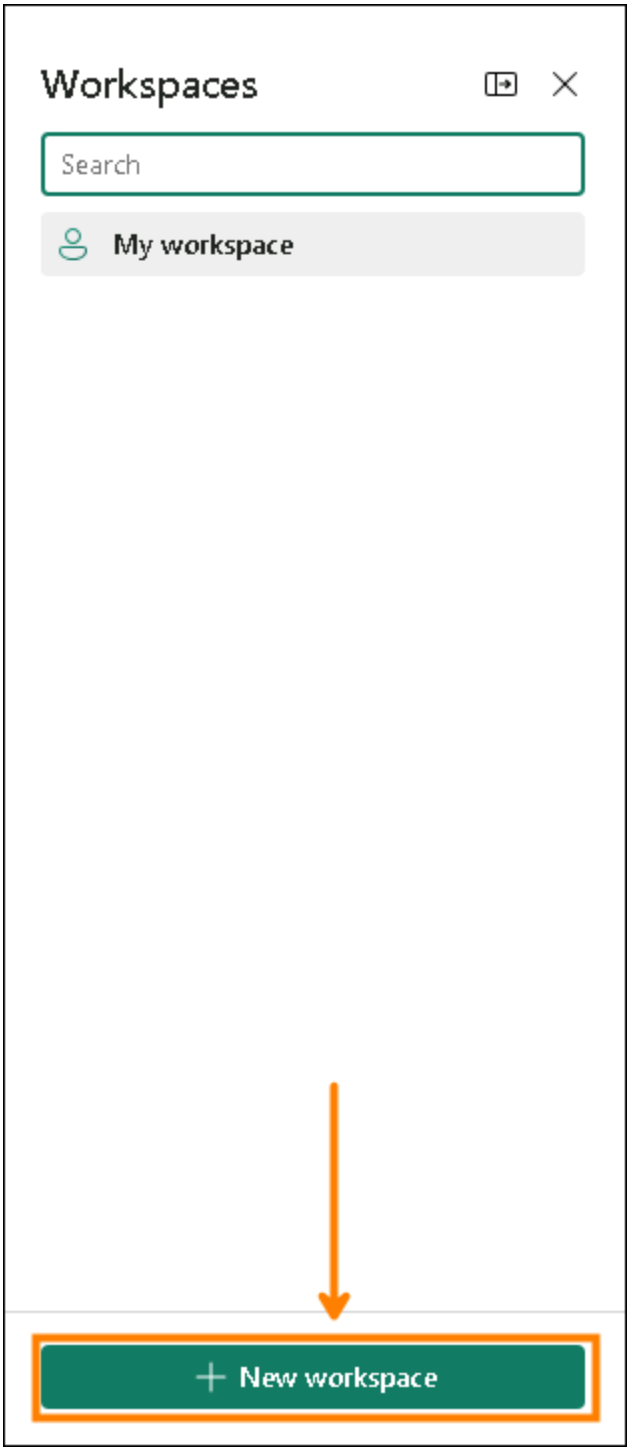

4. Enter the provided **Temporary Access Pass** from the credentials page or your lab document and press **Sign in**. Optionally, select Yes to remain signed in.
    - **Password:**



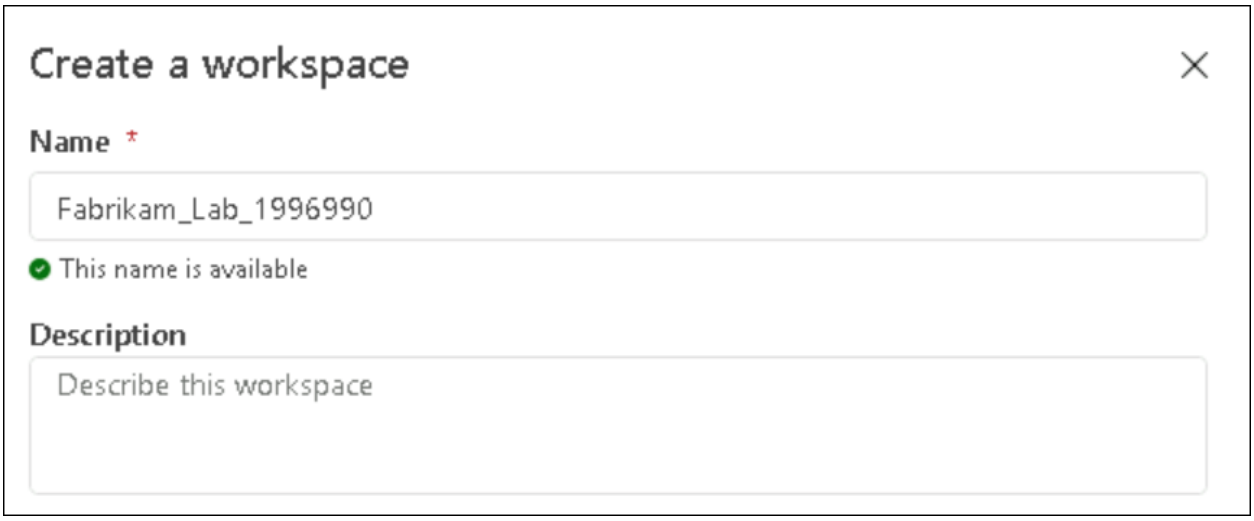

5. We will first navigate to the **Workspaces** area on the left-hand side menu.



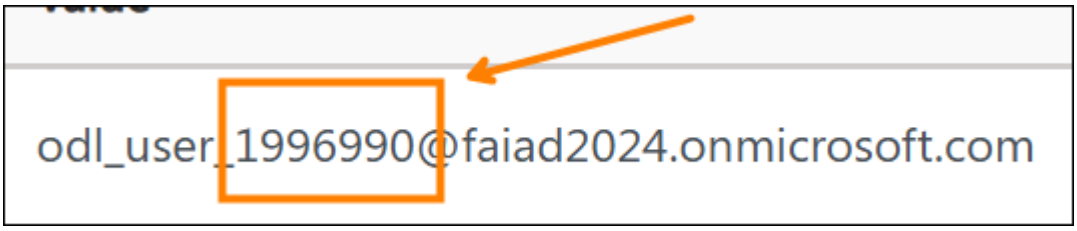

6. We will now create a **+ New workspace** by selecting the New Workspace button.



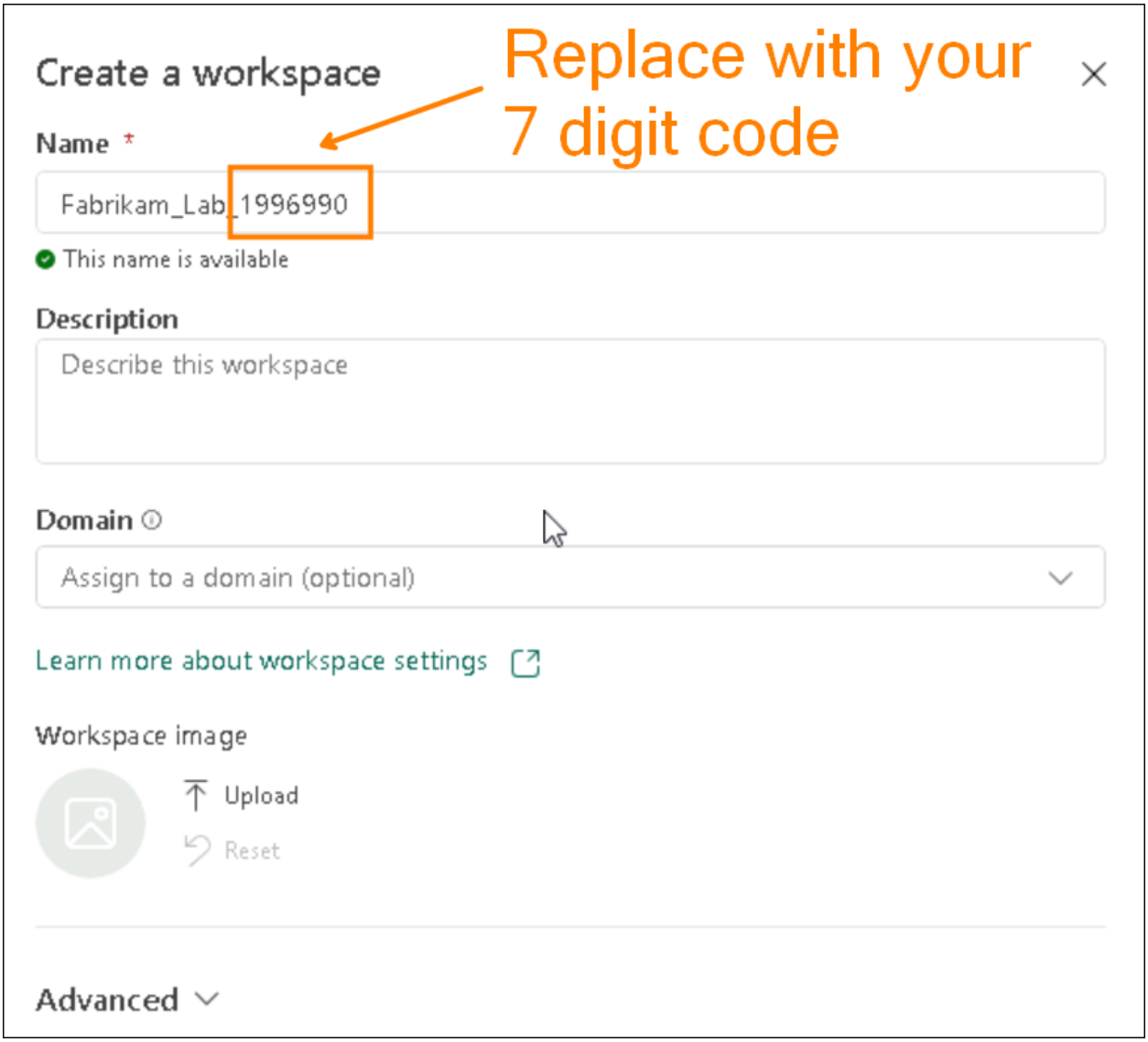

7. Next, name your workspace: **Fabrikam_Lab_**




8. Your 7 digit code is part of the username you were assigned for the class. Please use this! See screenshot below.

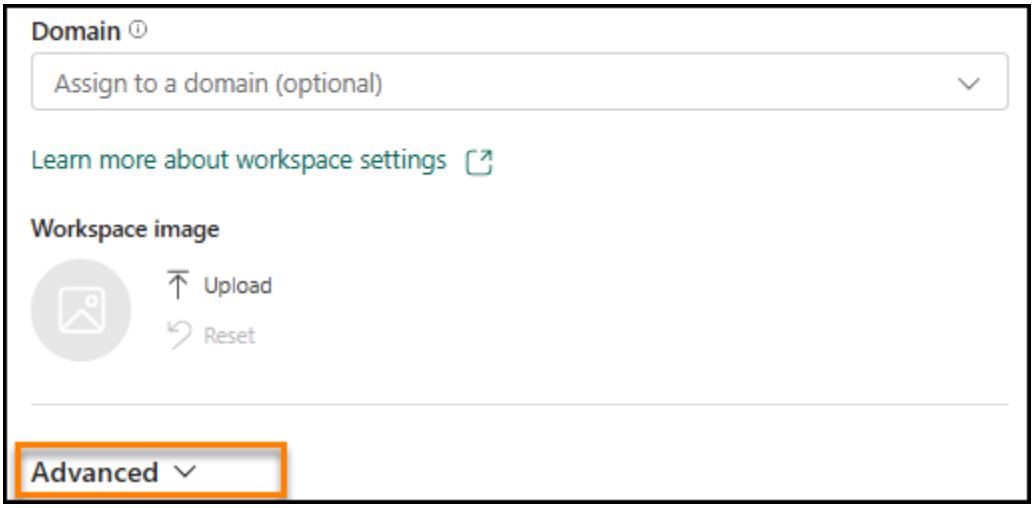



9. For example, John A. Smith would be: **Fabrikam_Lab_000**



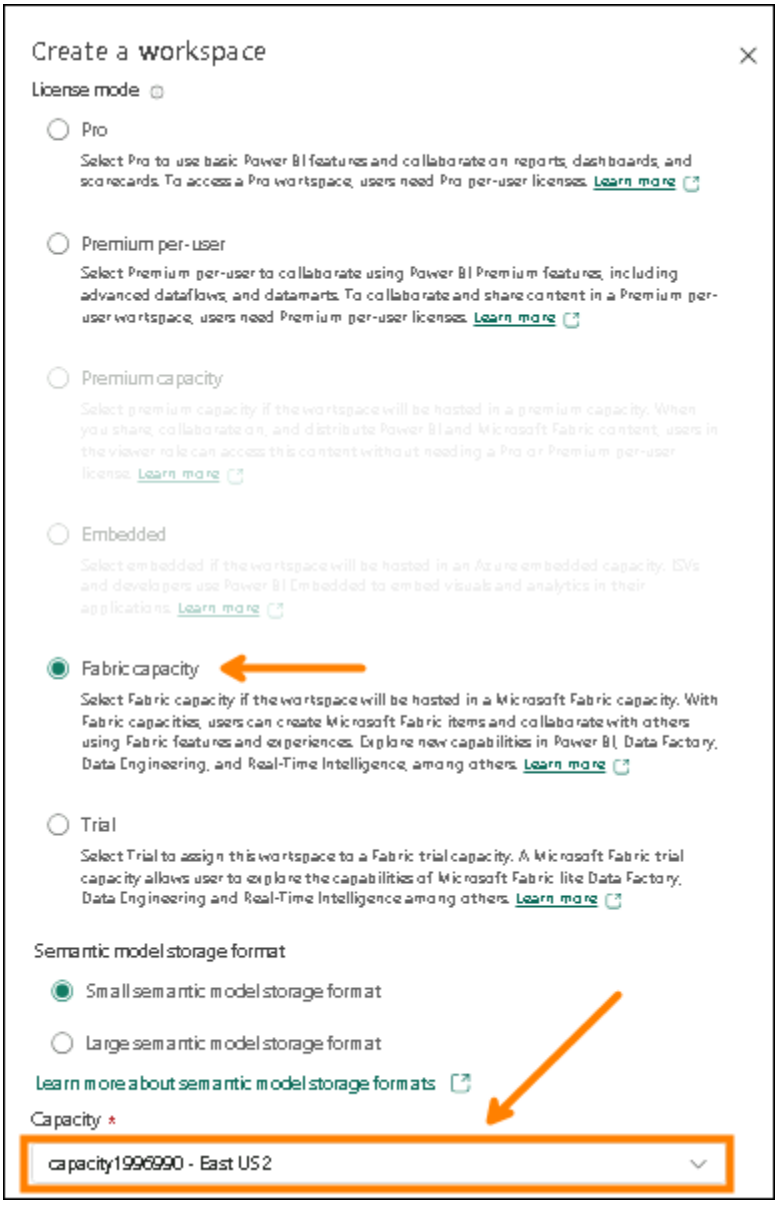

10. Next, you need to assign a Fabric capacity to your workspace.

11. Click **Advanced** to expand the advanced options when setting up a workspace.

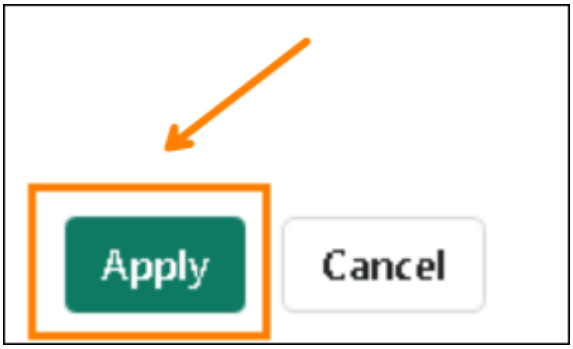



**Important:** The fabric environment used for this class will be updated often so you MAY NOT have the same capacities listed in the screenshot below. Just choose any available capacity!

12. Make sure that **Fabric Capacity** is selected. Scroll down a little further and select, **at random**, a capacity from the drop-down menu!

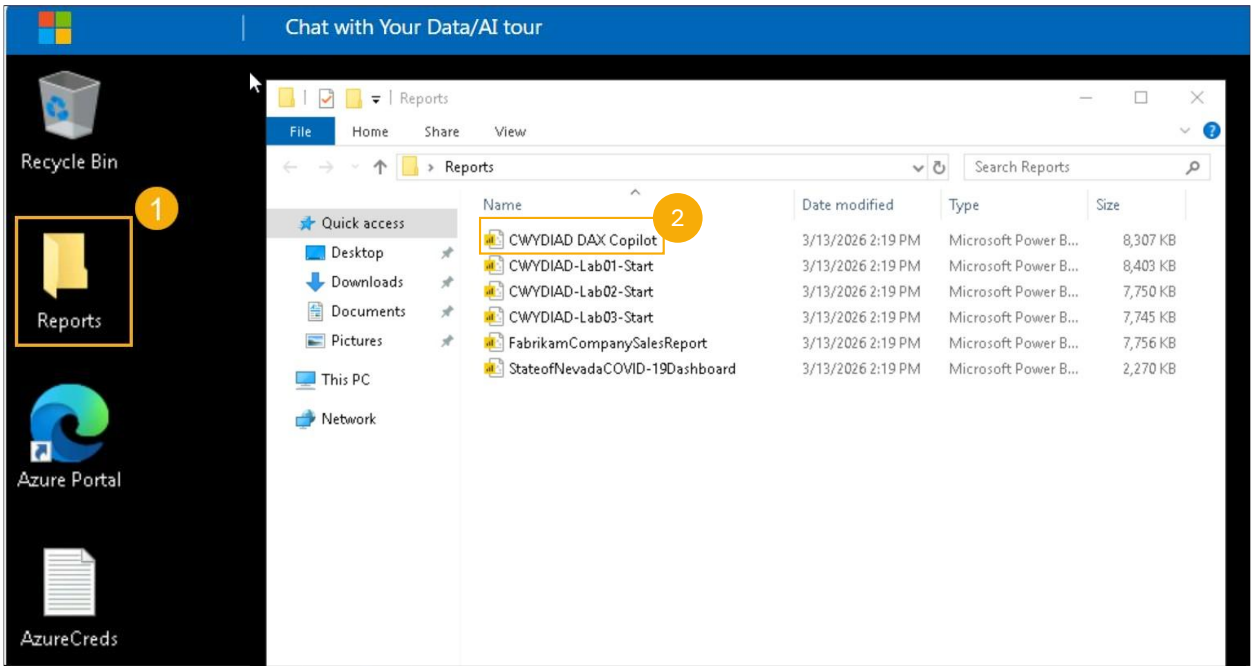



13. Click **Apply**.

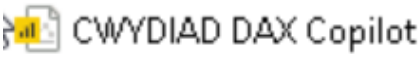


Great! We will be using the Fabric Capacity Workspace to explore all the best that Chat with Your Data has to offer!

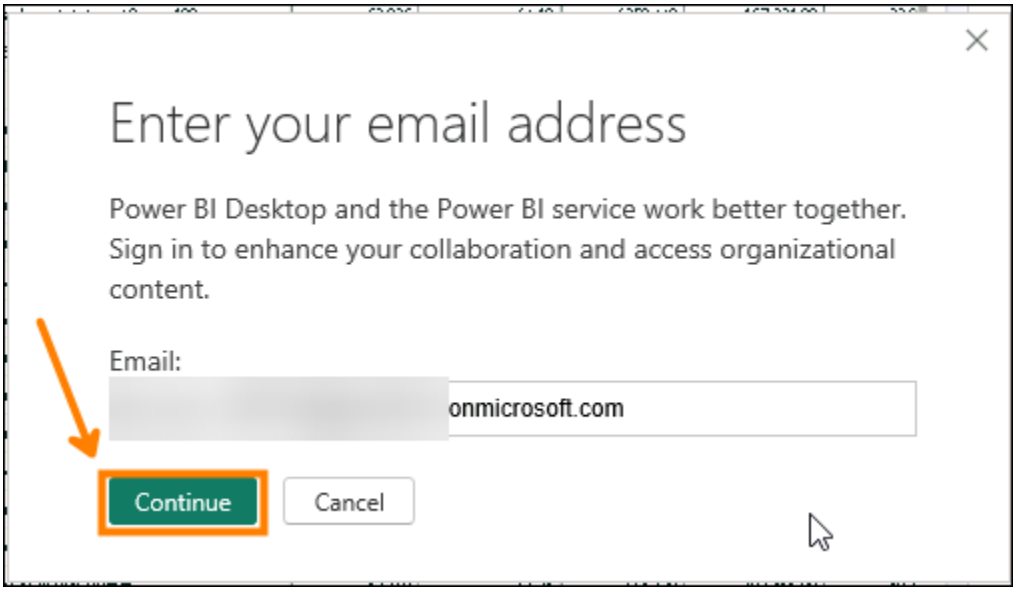
14. From the desktop, open the **Reports** folder and double-click **CWYDIAD DAX Copilot** to open the report.



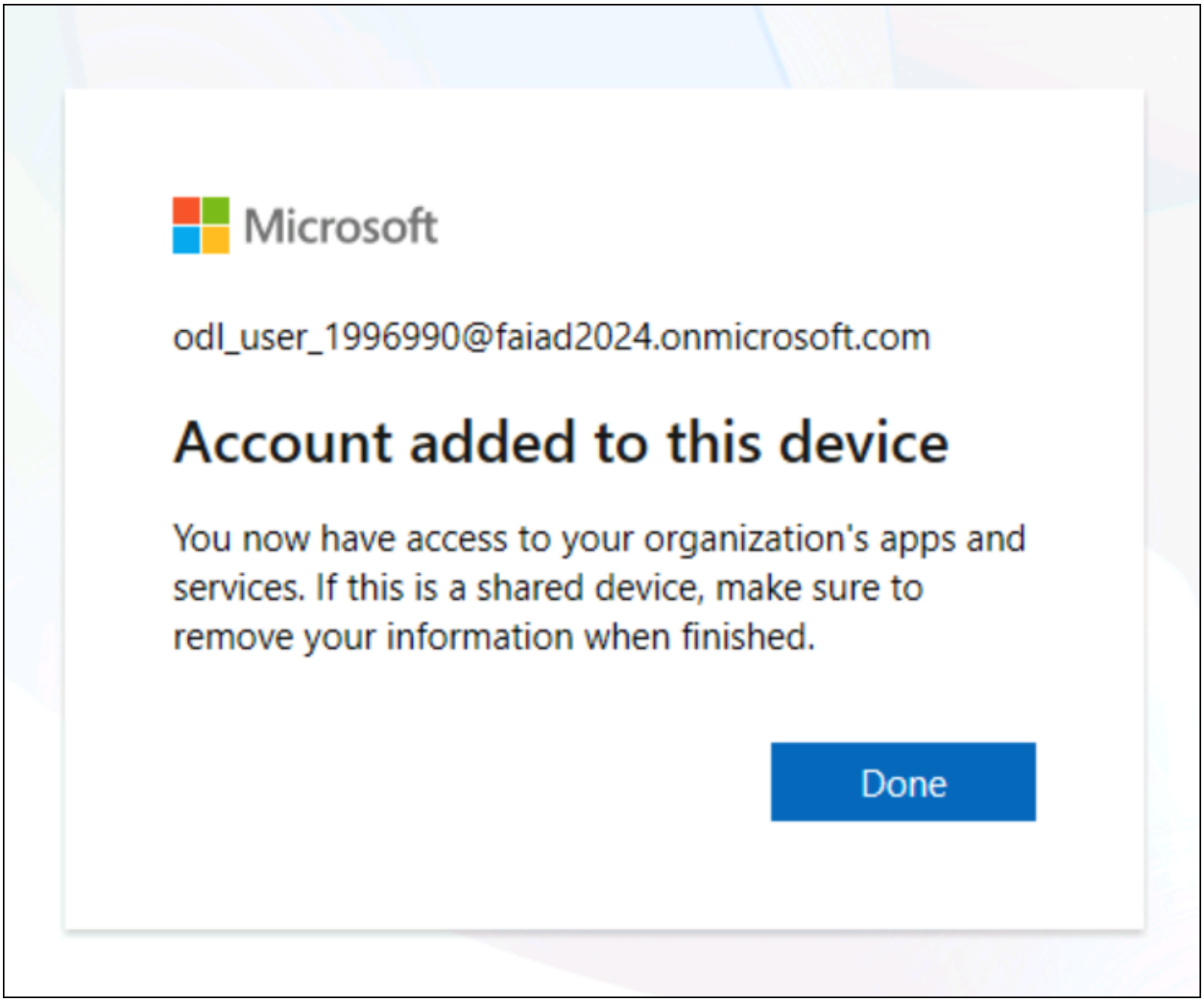

15. Open the file titled **"CWYDIAD DAX Copilot"** located in the **reports** folder on the **labvm desktop**. your class files to begin exploring the chat with your data experience.




16. Enter your email address as into the Power BI Desktop file and press continue to log in using your credentials:



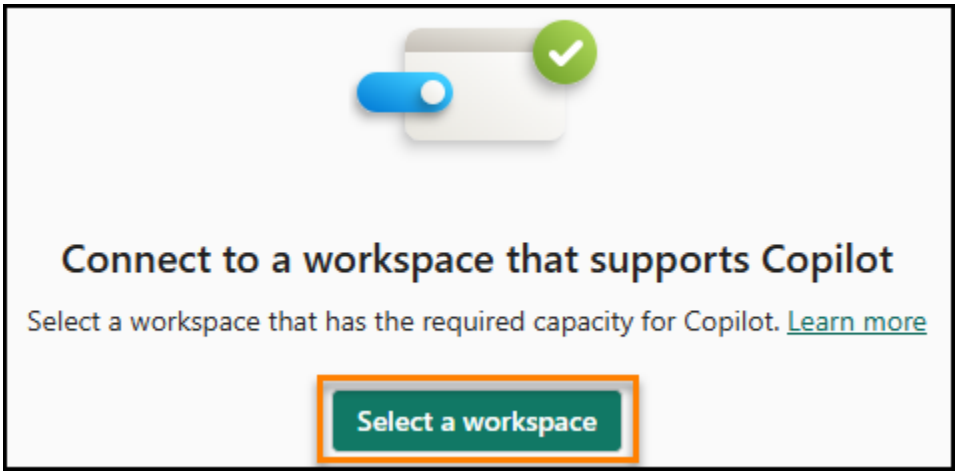

17. Additionally, log in via the Microsoft login window using the same Username : and Temporary Access Pass : .

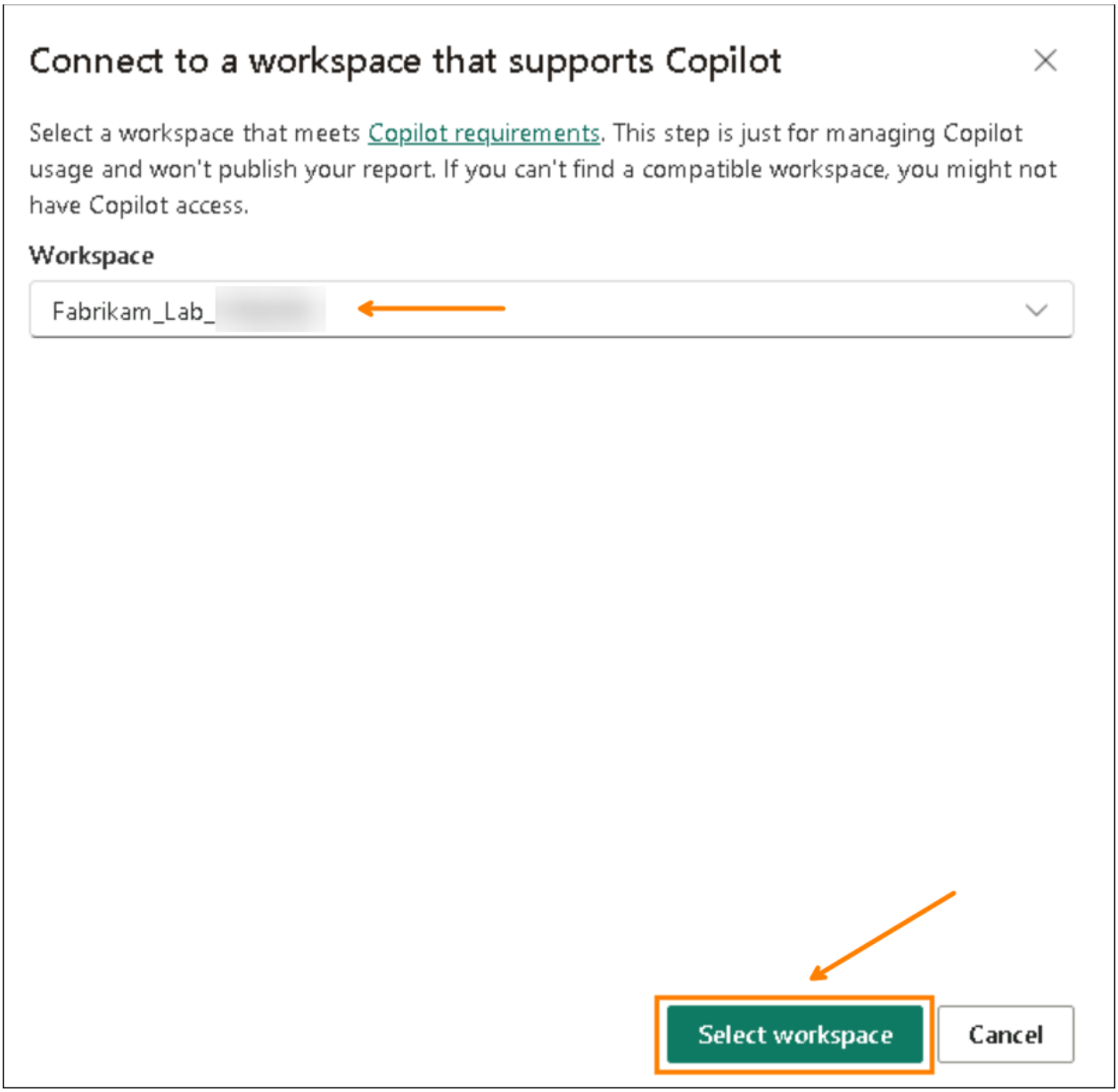



Note: If a popup asks to "Sign in to all apps", select "Yes"

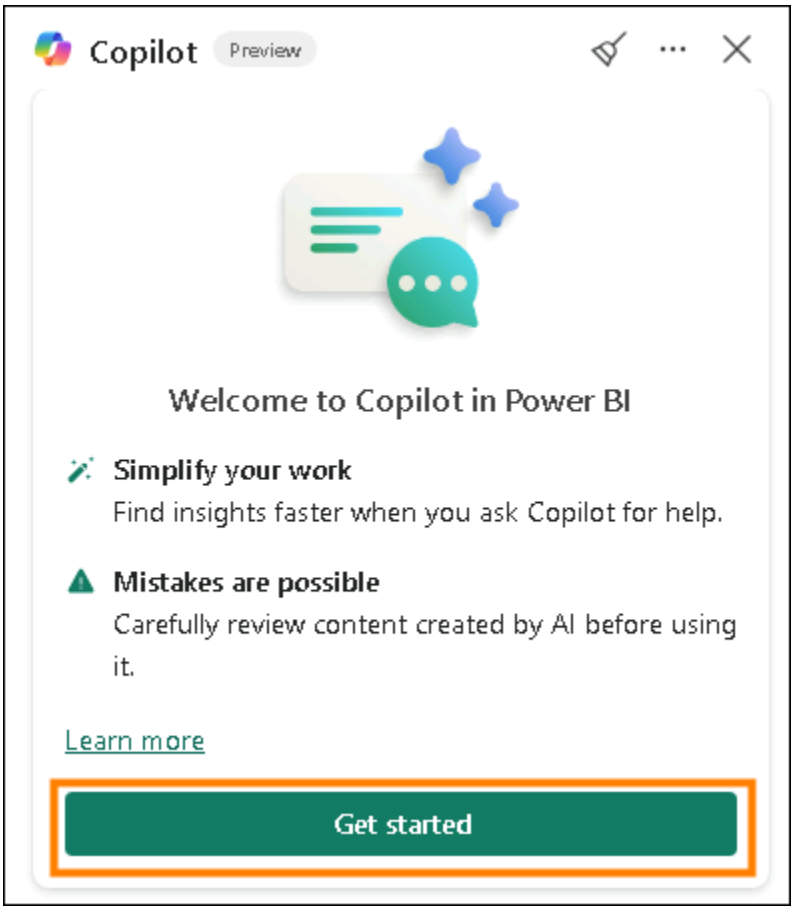
18. With the starting PBIX file open, proceed to the Copilot button and select it to open the Copilot experience.

19. If you are already logged in, a new window opens for **Connect to a workspace that supports Copilot.** Click the **Select a Workspace** option and select the workspace you just created.

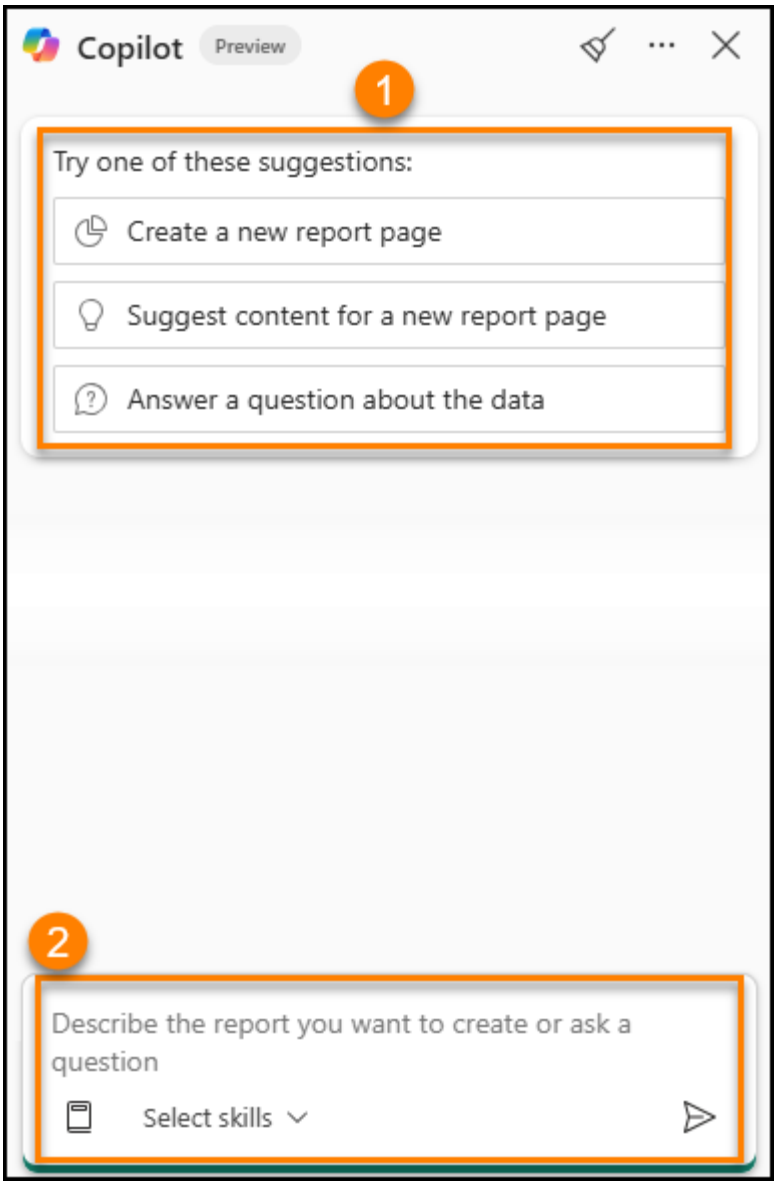

Connect to a workspace that supports Copilot
Select a workspace that has the required capacity for Copilot. Learn more
Select a workspace


Connect to a workspace that supports Copilot
Select a workspace that meets Copilot requirements. This step is just for managing Copilot usage and won't publish your report. If you can't find a compatible workspace, you might not have Copilot access.
Workspace
Fabrikam_Lab_
Select workspace
Cancel

20. If you receive a prompt on the next screen, click on **Get started**.



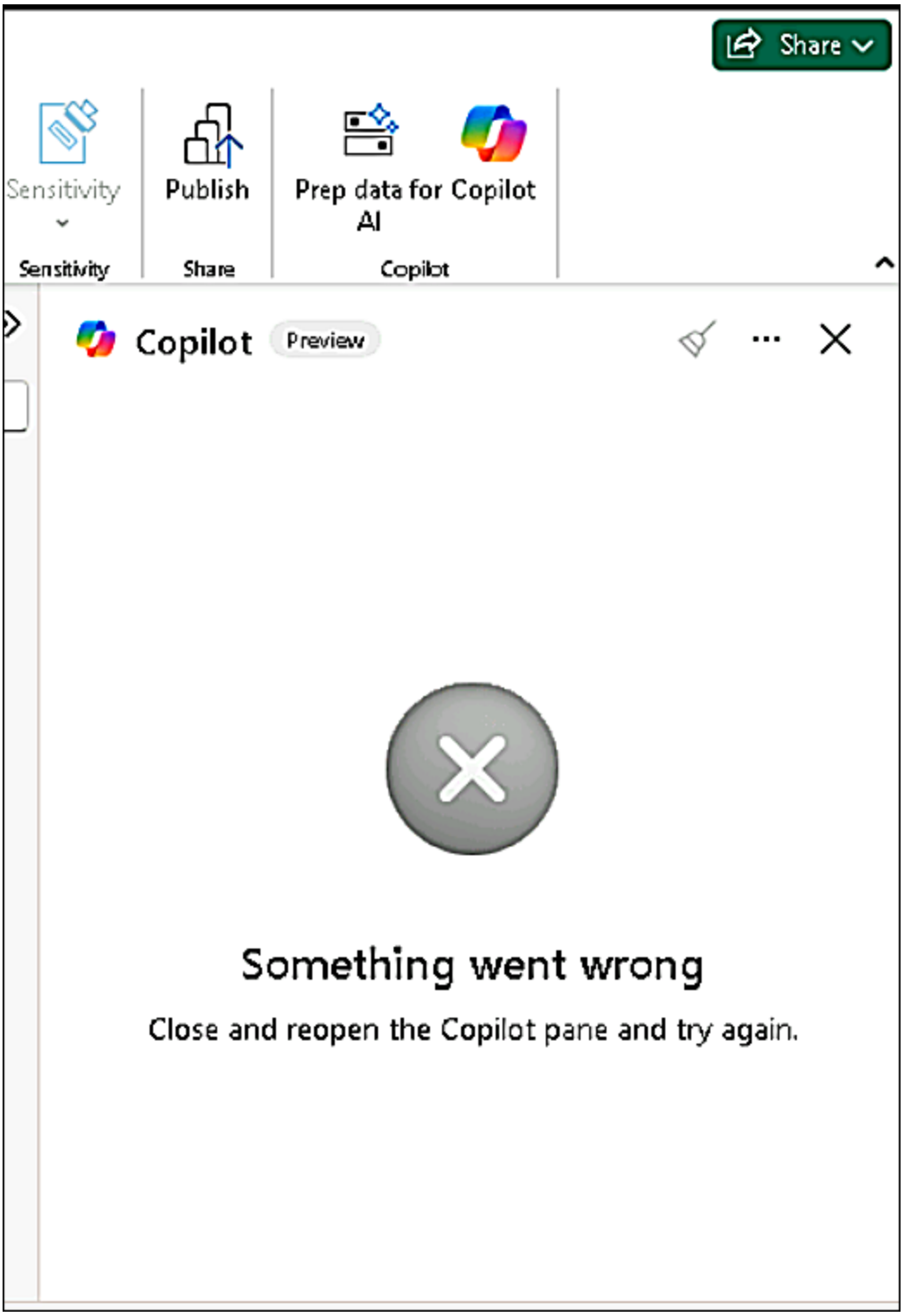

21. Welcome to the Copilot experience in Power BI! On this startup screen you will receive some prompt ideas across the top **(1)** and then a section at the bottom where you can write out your request **(2)**.



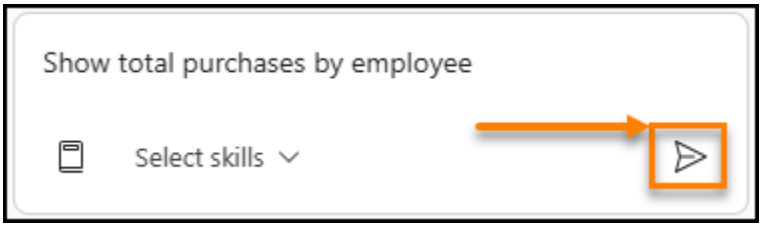

## Task 2: Writing a prompt in Power BI Copilot

In this section, you will write various prompts and explore the results returned by the Power BI Copilot experience.

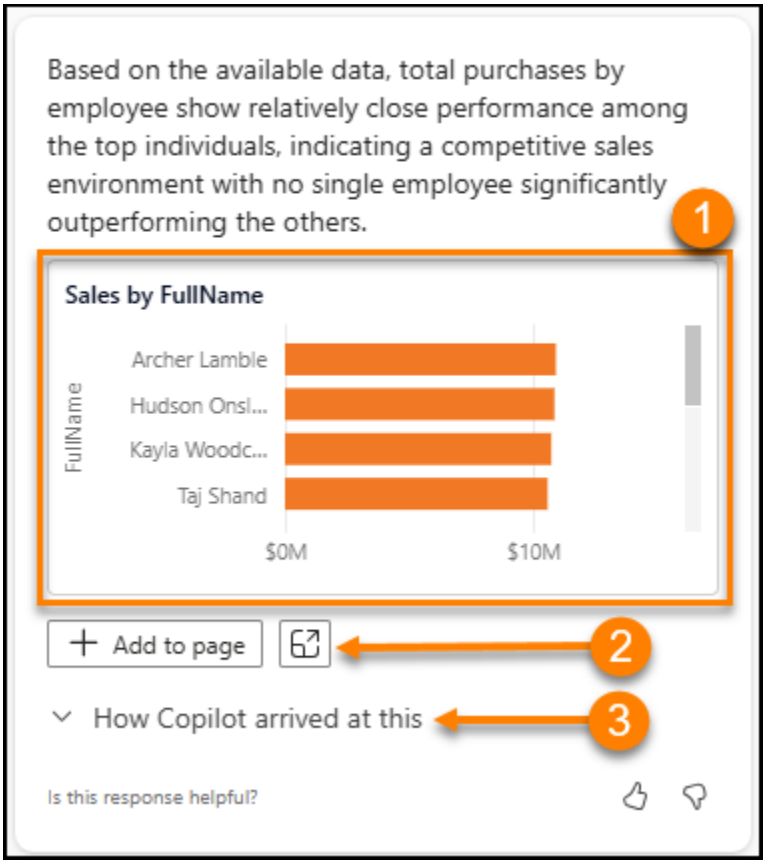
**Note:** While accessing Copilot chat, if you encounter an error as shown in the screenshot below, please close the Copilot pane and restart Power BI Desktop. If the issue persists, sign out of Power BI Desktop and sign in again, then retry accessing Copilot.




1. Click in the prompt and write out the following: **Show total purchases by employee**. Then click **Enter**.




**Potential Options:**



This answer required more analysis than usual. Check it carefully, AI can make mistakes. Learn more

Advanced: Check the DAX

Based on the available data, the total purchases by employee are shown in the table below. **Kayla Woodcock** is the only employee listed, with **total purchases of 3,856,333,238**.

| People FullName | Total Purchases |
|---|---|
| Kayla Woodcock | 3856333238 |

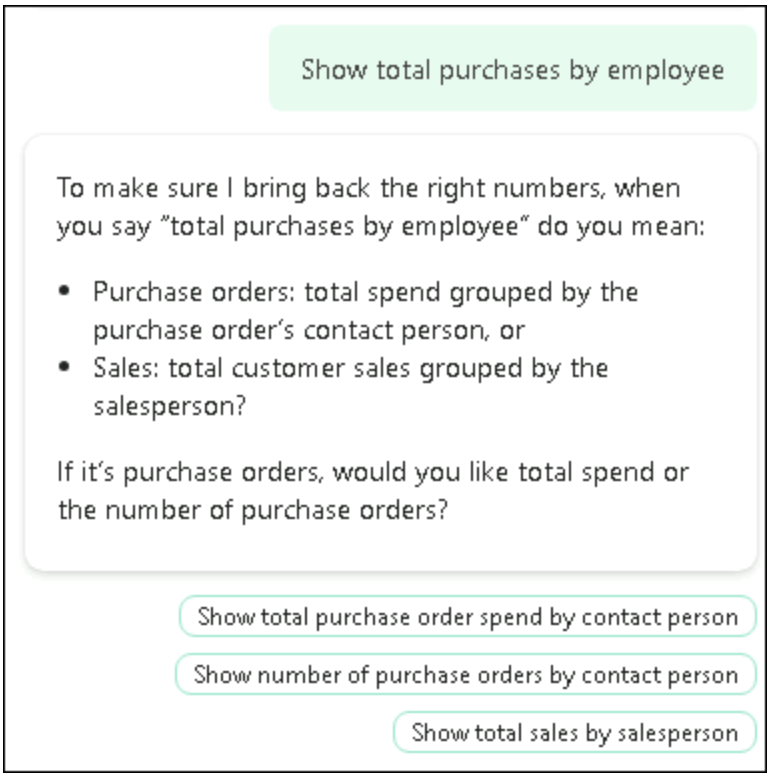
Expand answer

How Copilot arrived at this

Is this response helpful?

**Important:** AI returns non-deterministic results due to many factors. As discussed previously in this class, your results may vary and may not be identical to the labs. Note above that this unprepped for AI data will have varied results on the exact same question. Please proceed and explore the capabilities and features being displayed to the best of your ability!

You may even get asked follow-up questions like the one listed below:



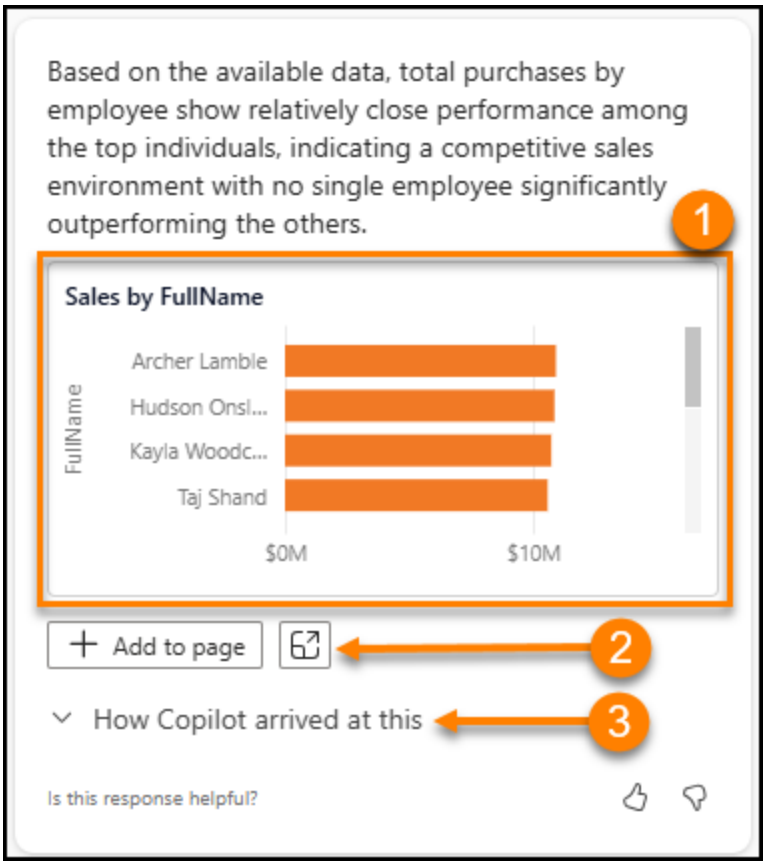

If needed, choose the most like **Show total purchases by employee** or **continue prompting.**

2. A lot of information is now returned. Let's explore this section in depth.

a. **(1)** A visualization comparing the Total Purchases and Employees.

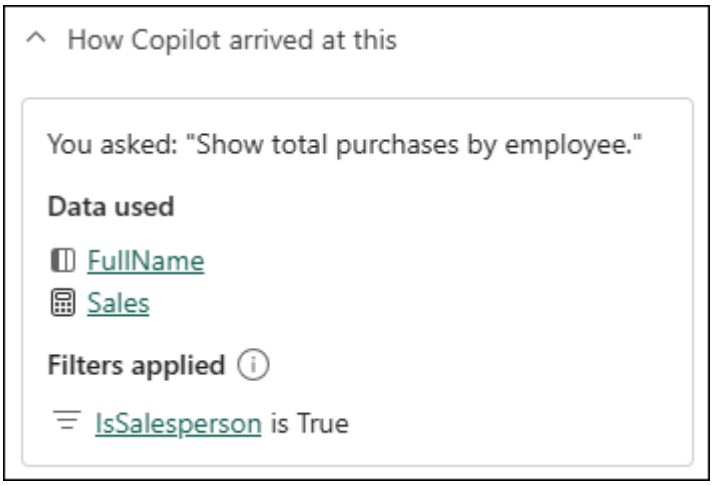
b. **(2)** Areas to **Add to page** or to **pop-out** and **expand** the visual.

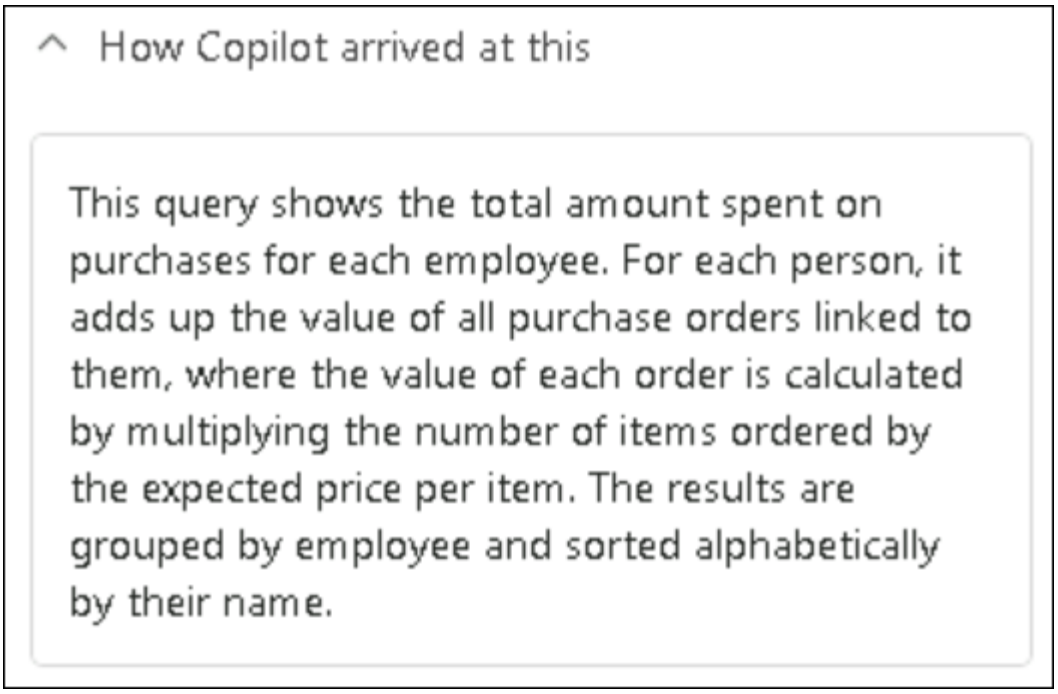
c. **(3)** *HCAAT:* How Copilot arrived at this.



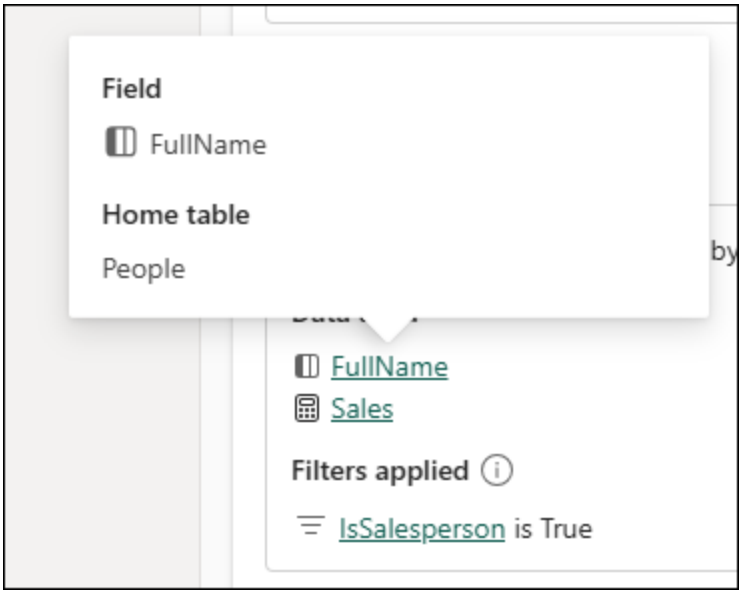

3. Click on the *HCAAT*: **How Copilot arrived at this** button to see the logic behind the Copilot answer.

**Potential Options:**






4. Hover over the ***FullName***, ***Sales***, and even ***IsSalesperson*** to see both the **Field** and **Home Table** for what Copilot has used in the answering of the question.




Unfortunately, this is an incorrect result. We asked for Total Purchases and received **Total Sales** instead! The other DAX Query only looked at a single employee. Looks like this data need preparation! Think about it this way, data that has not been prepped for Copilot is like a brand new, first day on the job, data analyst and data that has been

prepped for Copilot is like asking a question to a seasoned analyzed with many years experience in YOUR specific organization.

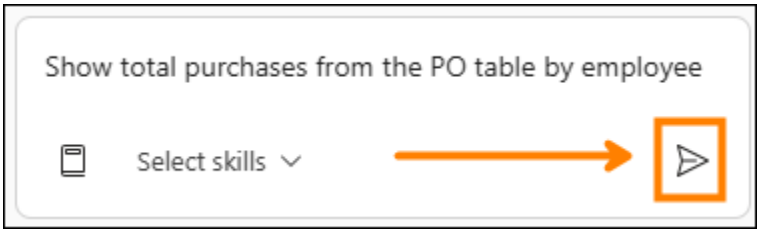
There are two main things to think about here when prepping data for Copilot.

First, we can write a better prompt that provides more specificity, this will definitely help. However, many users won't know how to write effective prompts and they also may not know the data well enough to be specific.

Secondly, as data analysts, we can prepare the data for Copilot and anticipate these types of requests making the Copilot responses more accurate. The object of this class is to teach you all the best practices and tooling available to improve the Chat with your Data experience.

**Important:** Copilot's responses are shaped by how you ask your questions. Clear, specific prompts lead to more accurate insights and faster solutions. When working with your data, try to include context, desired outcomes, and any relevant filters or columns. The better your prompt, the better your response!

5. Let's try this again, but with a more specific prompt, in the Copilot Prompt type: **Show total purchases from the PO table by employee.**



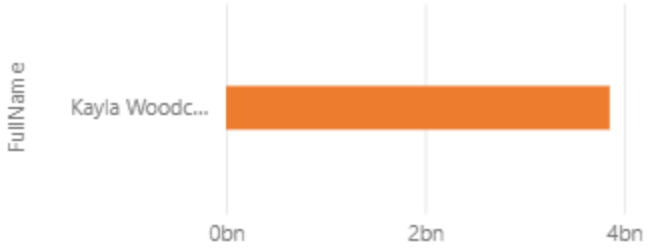

6. You will notice that the visual created only has one Employee named "Kayla Woodcock". This is correct! Kayla is the only employee who makes purchases. So by being more specific we can achieve better responses. In addition, if we had prepped our semantic model with a measure named Total Purchases from the beginning we could have avoided this scenario!

**Potential Options:**

Show total purchases from the PO table by employee

Based on the available data, Kayla Woodcock is the only employee listed with total purchases amounting to 3,856,333,238 from the PO table. No other employee data is provided.

**Spend by FullName**




Add to page

How Copilot arrived at this

Is this response helpful?

This answer required more analysis than usual. Check it carefully, AI can make mistakes. Learn more

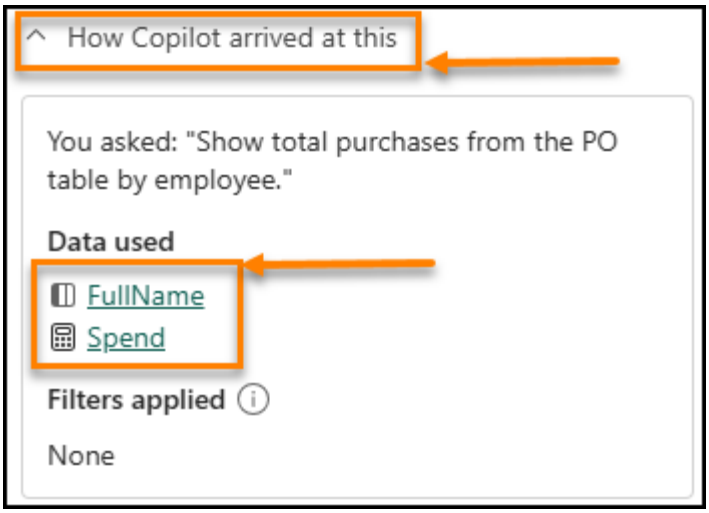
Advanced: Check the DAX

Based on the available data, the total purchases from the PO table by employee are shown in the table below. Only **Kayla Woodcock** (PersonID 2) has recorded purchases, with a total spend of **$3,856,333,238**.

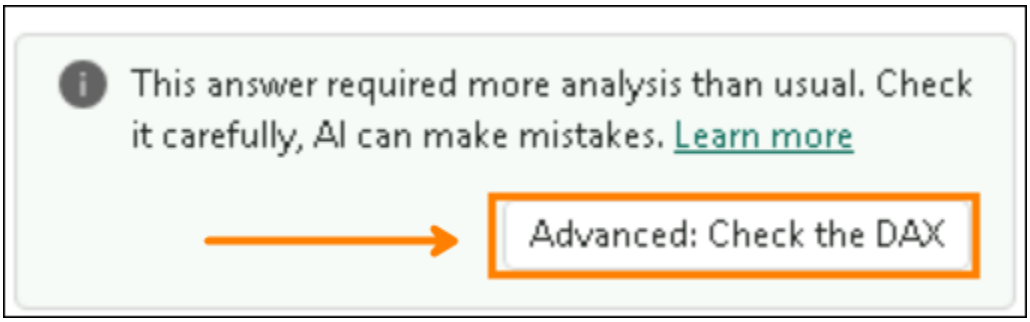
| People FullName | People PersonID | Total Purchases |
|---|---|---|
| Kayla Woodcock | 2 | 3856333238 |

Expand answer

7. It's very important to always validate the results and how Copilot arrived at the answer. Click on the **HCAAT**, How Copilot arrived at this.




If Copilot provides a DAX query try pressing **Check the DAX**.




8. We can see Copilot is using the FullName column from our People table and it is also using the Spend measure. Even our DAX query is doing the same. The spend measure could probably be named better to improve the Copilot experience.

```
EVALUATE
  SUMMARIZECOLUMNS(
    'People'[FullName],
    'People'[PersonID],
    "Total Purchases", [Spend]
  )
```

9. What does Spend mean here in this context? Is it the same thing as Purchases? It's possible we are still getting the incorrect response from Copilot. Let's go ahead and ask Copilot to explain to us how Spend is calculated!

10. In your Copilot prompt type: **How is the measure Spend calculated**

**Potential Options:**

How is the measure Spend calculated

The measure "Spend" is a calculated column in your semantic model, specifically within the "PO" (Purchase Order) table. However, I do not have access to the exact formula or calculation logic used to derive "Spend" from your data. Typically, a "Spend" measure in a purchase order context might be calculated as the product of quantity ordered and unit price, but to confirm the precise calculation in your model, you would need to review the calculation definition within your Power BI semantic model or consult your data model documentation. If you need help locating or interpreting the calculation, let me know how you'd like to proceed.

Is this response helpful?

Based on the available data, the `Spend` measure is calculated using the formula **SUMX(PO, PO[OrderedOuters] * PO[ExpectedUnitPricePerOuter])**. This means it sums the product of `OrderedOuters` and `ExpectedUnitPricePerOuter` for each record in the `PO` table. The current value of this measure, given the active filter context, is **3,856,333,238**.

This calculation provides a total spend by multiplying the quantity ordered by the expected unit price for each purchase order and aggregating the results.

| Spend Measure Definition | Current Spend Value |
|---|---|
| SUMX(PO, PO[OrderedOuters] * PO[ExpectedUnitPricePerOuter]) | 3856333238 |

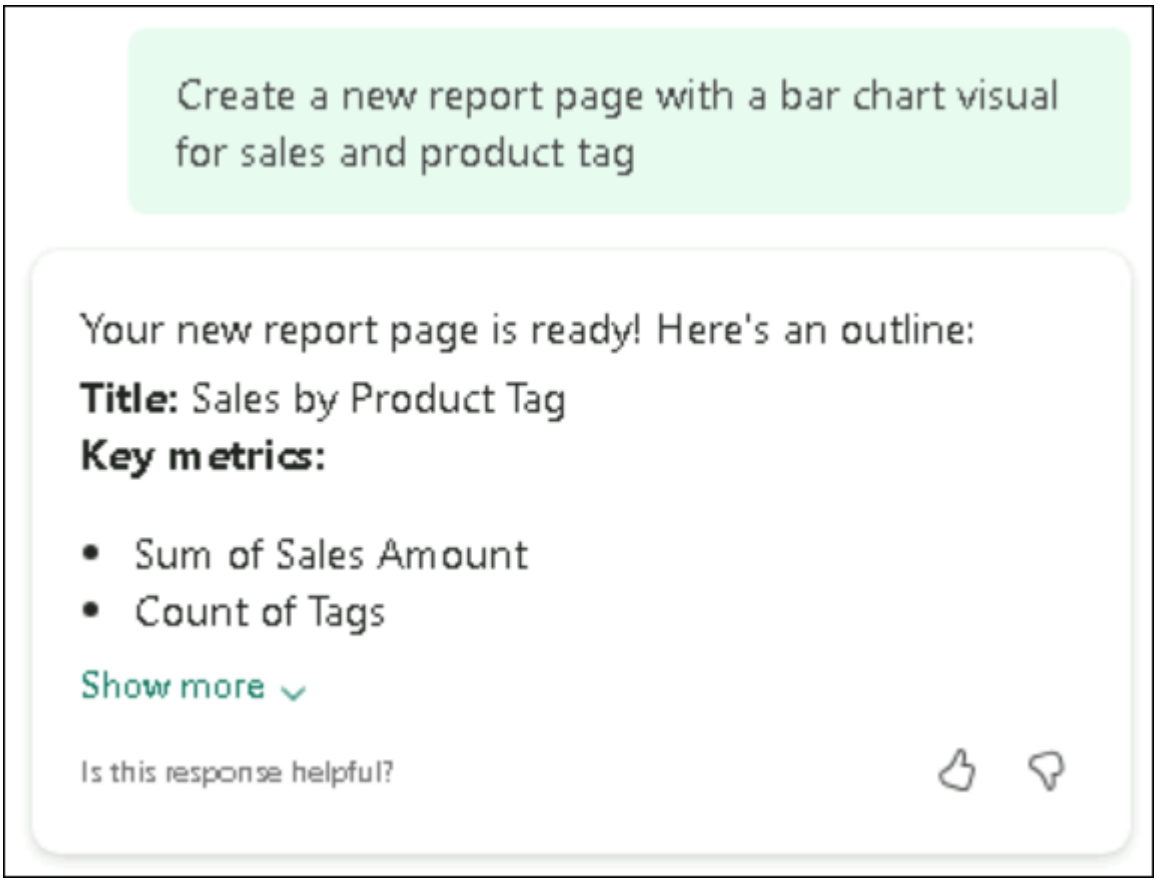
11. Copilot does a great job of giving a general explanation of what the calculation is probably doing. But you may see terms in this definition like "Typically" or "Usually" because this is a generalization. You may also notice that Copilot explicitly tells you that it does not have access to the exact formula or calculation logic and therefore cannot give you a specific answer.

In the other image, Copilot has been able to successfully grab the actual Measure, explain it, and provide the answer associated with spend within the current filter context!

**Important:** In a future lab, you will learn how to give Copilot additional business context necessary to answer these questions and give the user more confidence in the Copilot response!

12. Now let us expand further and create a visual to demonstrate how Copilot will adjust to changes in the data model and the report.

13. In your Copilot prompt type: **Create a new report page with a bar chart visual for sales and product tag.**




You **may** need to continue prompting Copilot as shown here:

It appears that the visuals could not be created because the exact measure, fields, and aggregations for "sales" and "product tag" need to be clarified. Could you please specify:

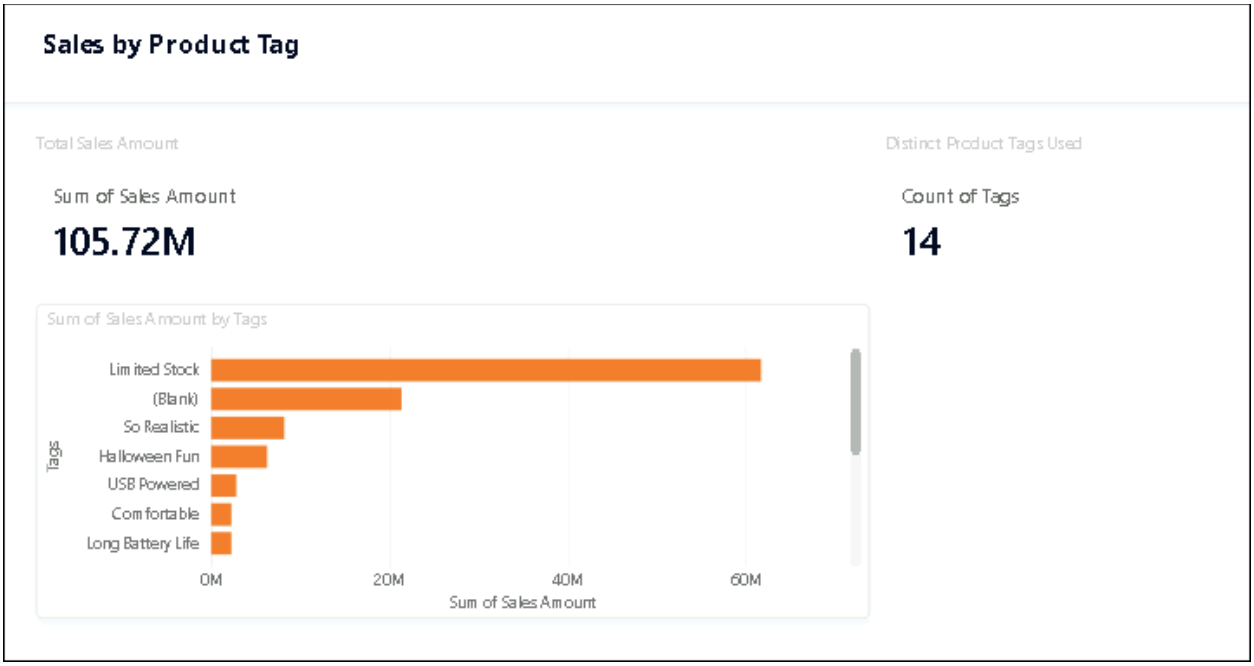
1. Which field should be used for "sales"? For example, do you want to use "Sales Amount" from the Sales table, or another field?
2. For "product tag," should I use the "Tags" field from the ProductDetails table?
3. What type of aggregation do you want for sales (e.g., total, average, count)?
4. Would you like to see sales broken down by each individual tag, or in another way?

Once you confirm these details, I can create the report page as requested.

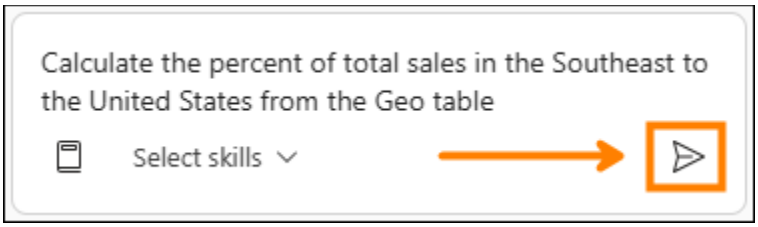
Is this response helpful?

Do your best to match the **Total Sales** and **Product Tag** elements.

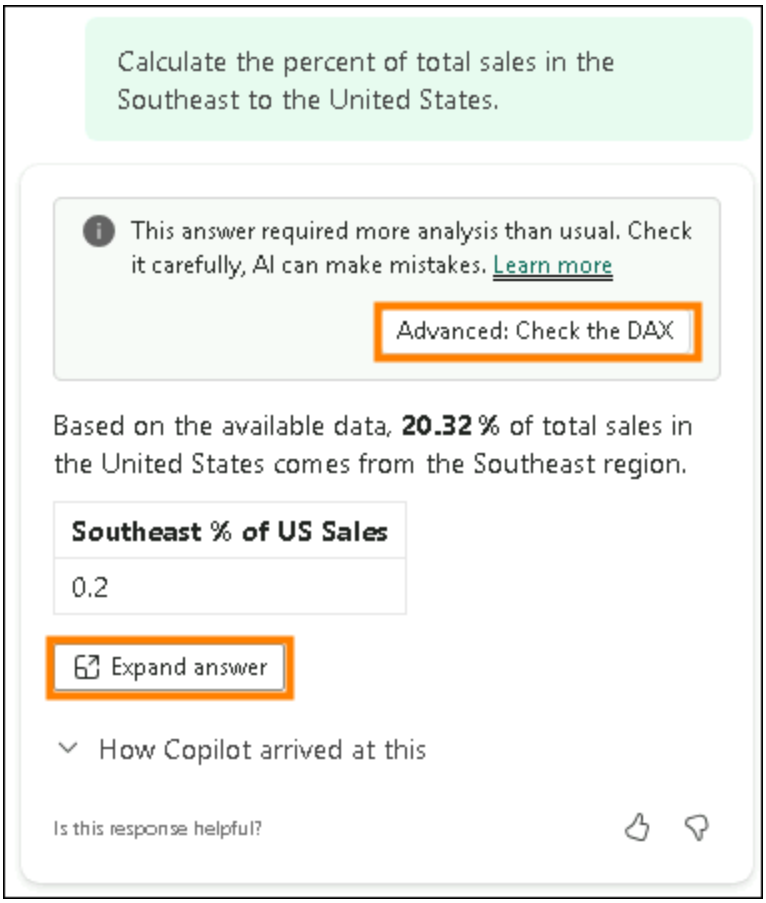
14. Notice Copilot has crafted the visual on a brand new report page!



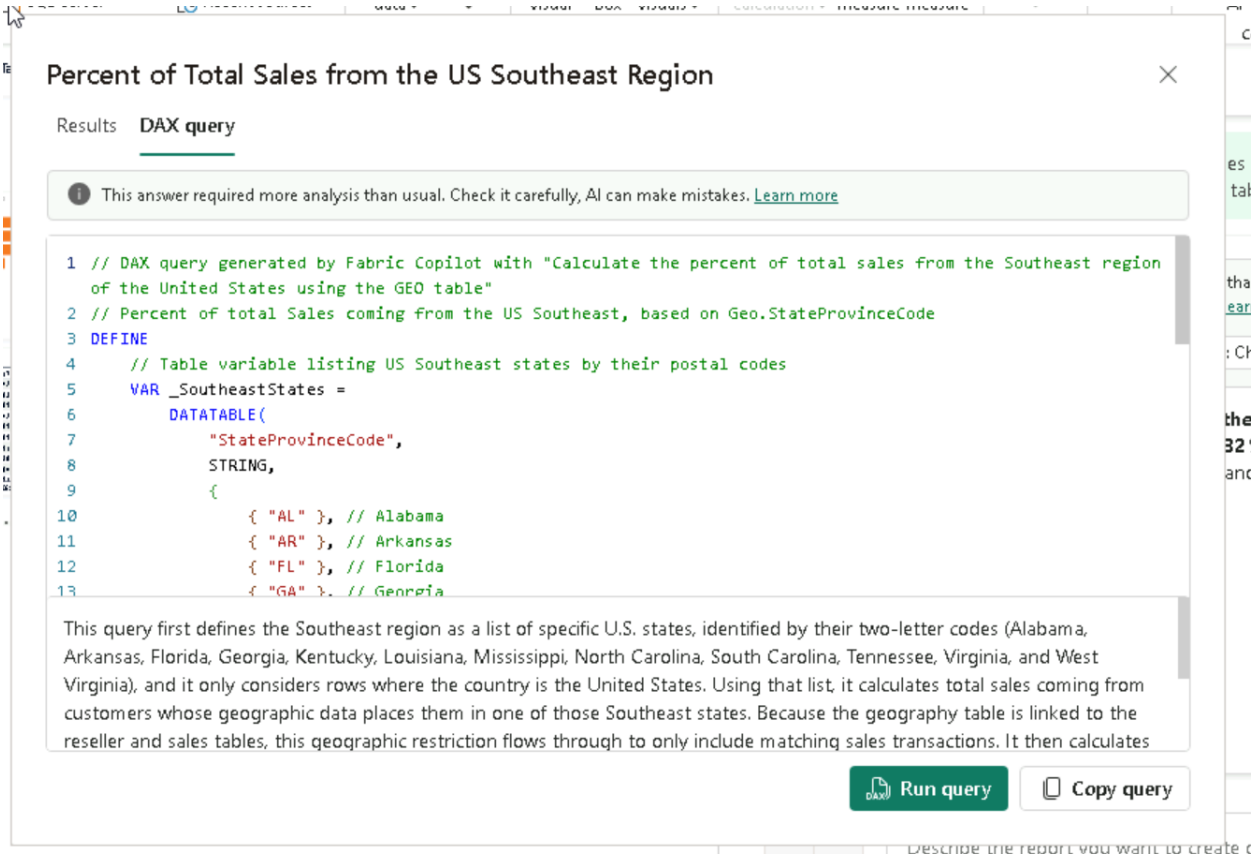
15. Ask Copilot: **Calculate the percent of total sales in the Southeast to the United States from the Geo table**.




16. We can check the DAX associated with the response.



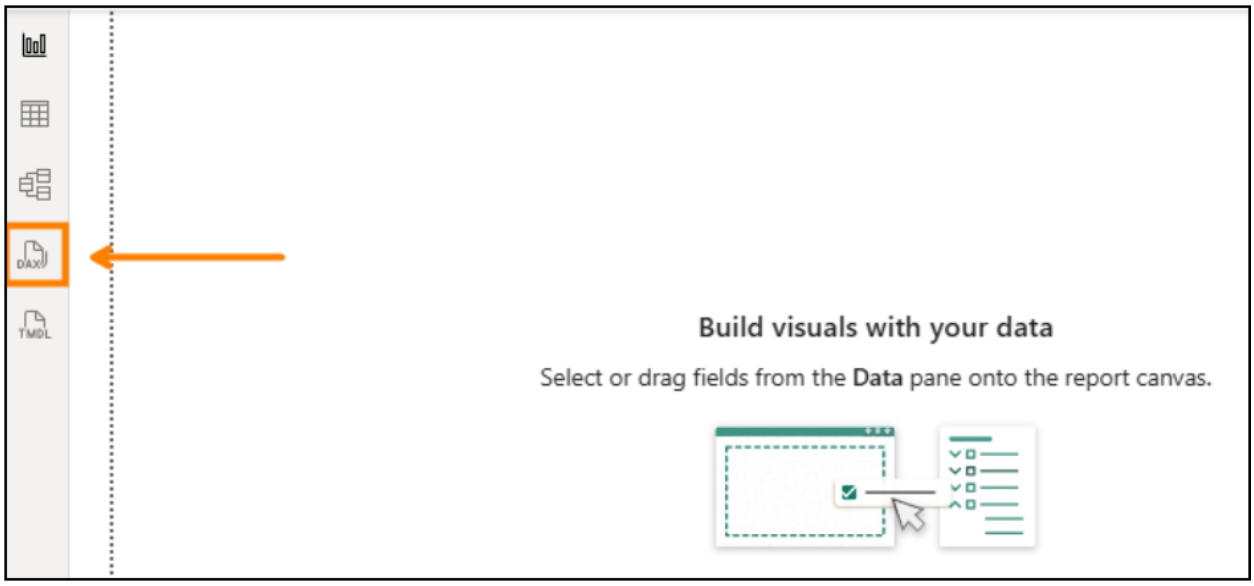

You want to ensure that you are viewing the **DAX Query** tab to view the DAX utilized to craft the answer. The query is listed along with an explanation of the logic to follow. Click Advanced: Check the DAX to look into the DAX measure.



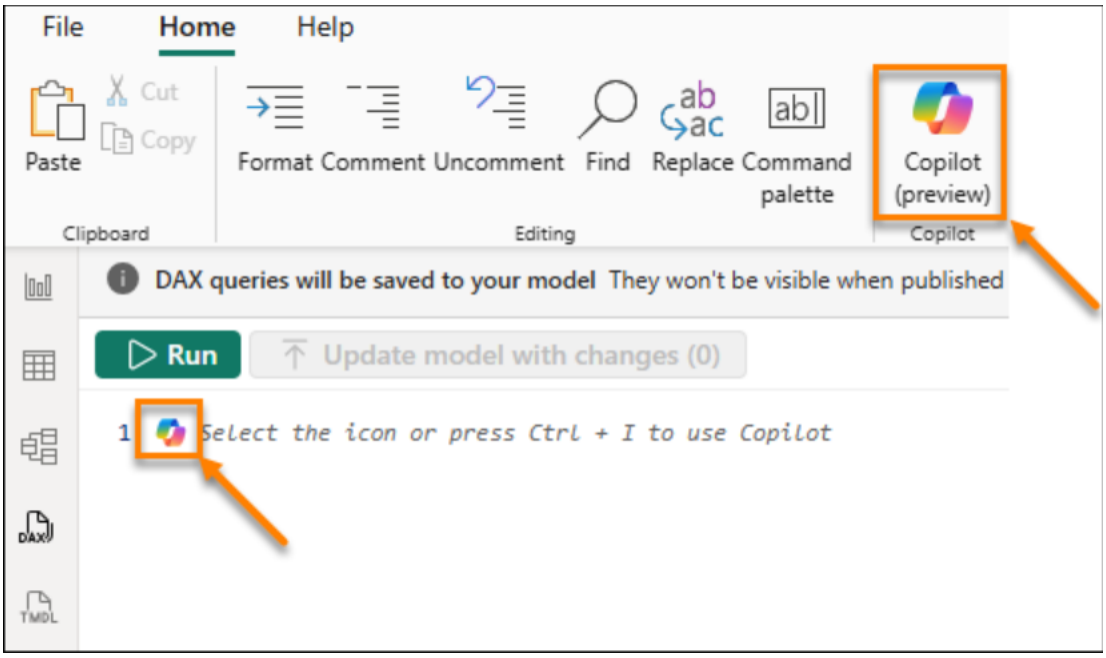

# Task 3: Creating Semantic Model Measures with Copilot

In this section we will use Copilot to create DAX measures.

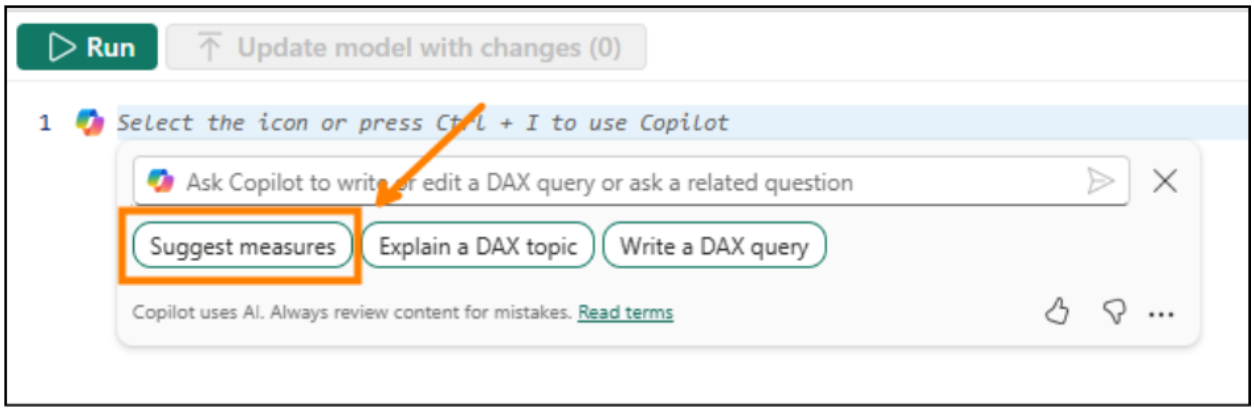
1. Navigate to the **DAX Query view** on the left menu.



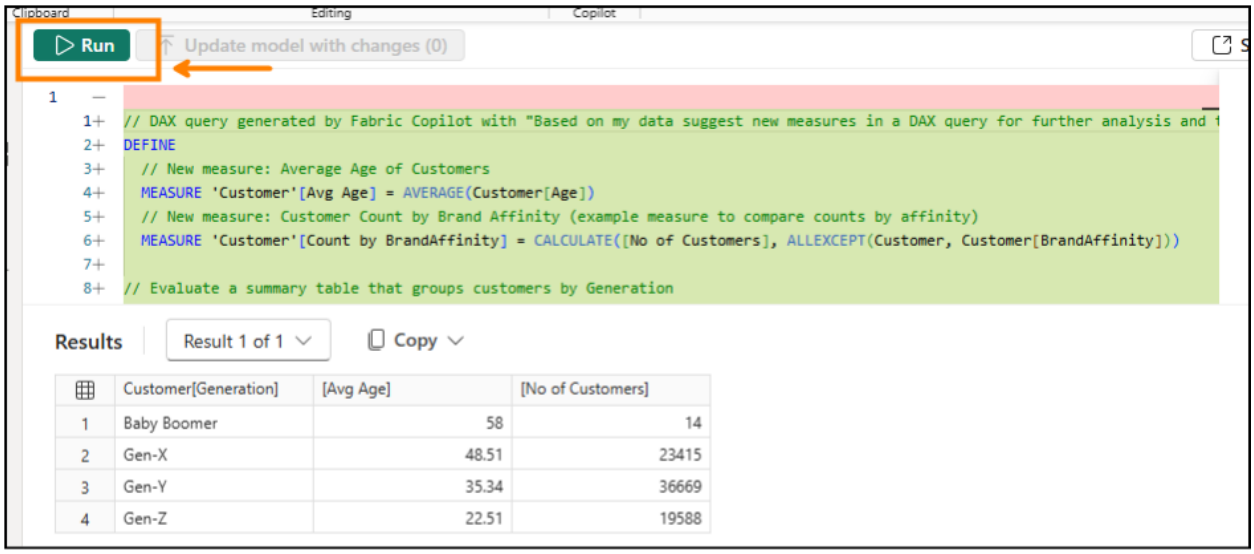

2. In the DAX Query Editor, **click the Copilot button**. You can select Copilot from the Home ribbon or from inside the Query, both options do the same thing!




3. Click the **Suggest measures** option.




4. Notice how several measures are suggested, along with commentary explaining each one. Click on the **Run** button.

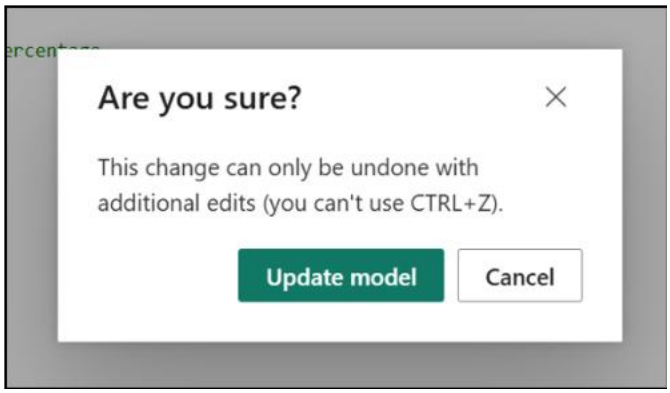



5. Scroll down to find and press the **Keep query** button.

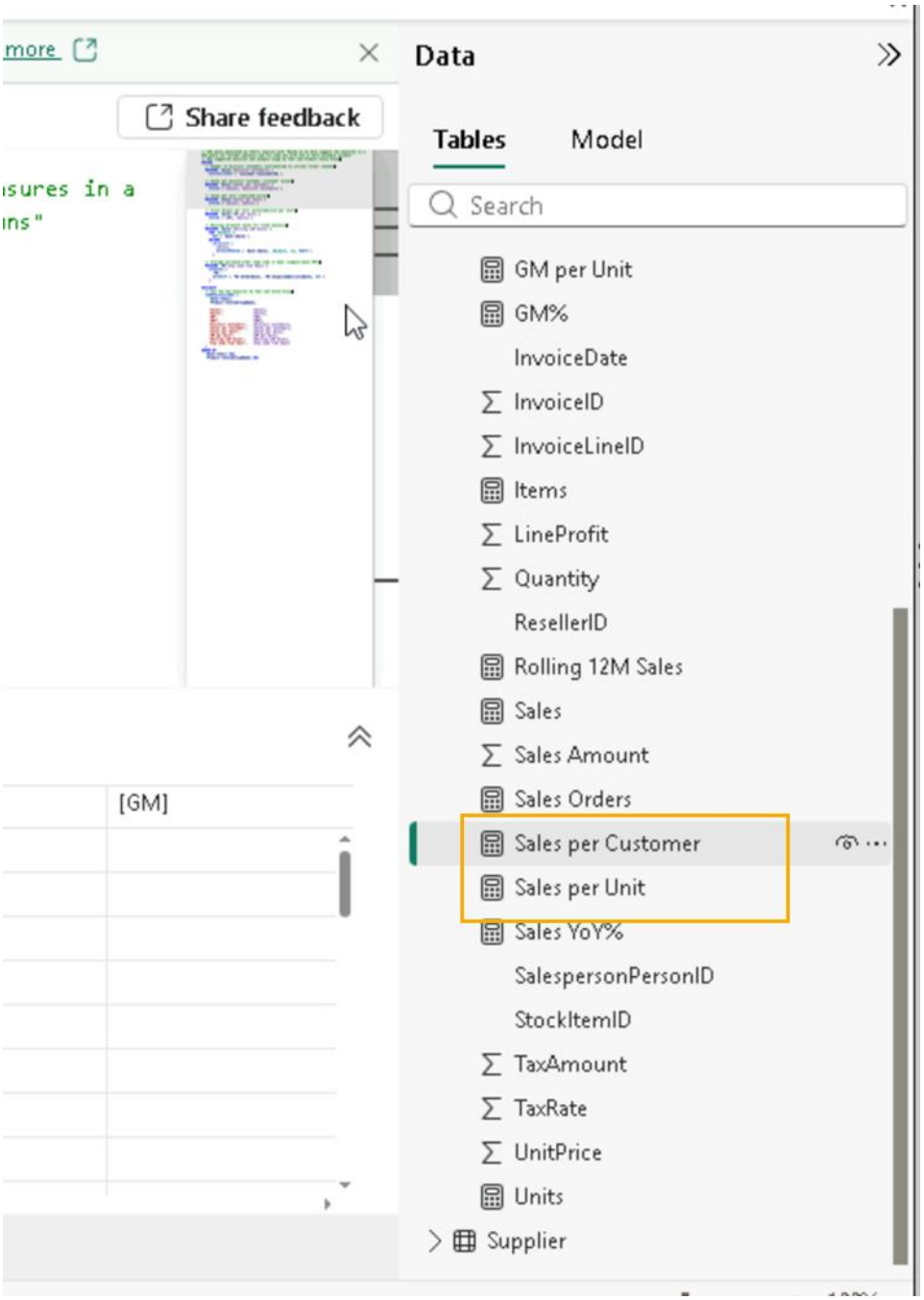
6. The **Keep query** button saves the query generated by Copilot into the current query tab that you have open. It is important to note that clicking on **keep query** does not add these measures to your model, it simply saves them here for later use.

7. If Copilot has generated a measure that you want to save in your data model, then you would click on **Update your model with changes.** This will take your query and commits it to the model, so the measures become part of the semantic model and they become available for use within your various report visuals. Select the **Update your model with changes** now.

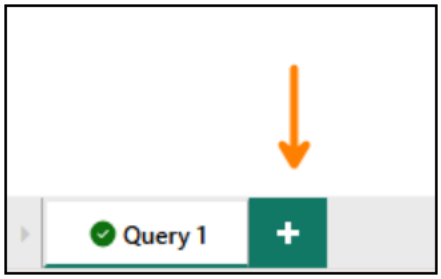
8. Confirm your decision in the next window.



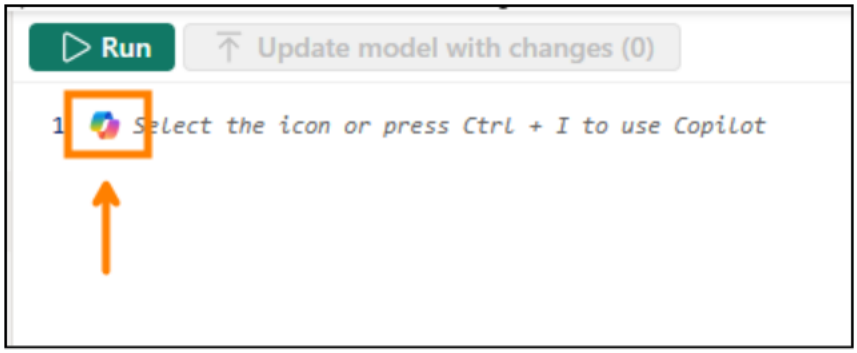
9. Look at the **Data pane** on the right side of your screen and find your measures. Notice the new measures are now present.



10. Create a new query by clicking the + button at the bottom left corner.

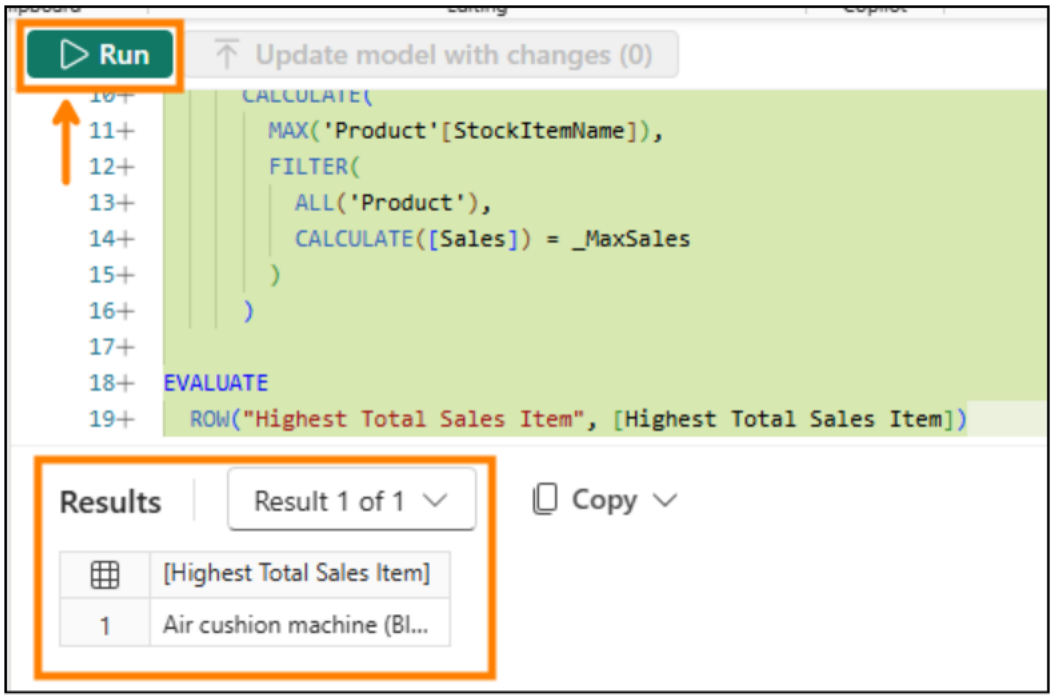



11. Click on the Copilot icon within the view.



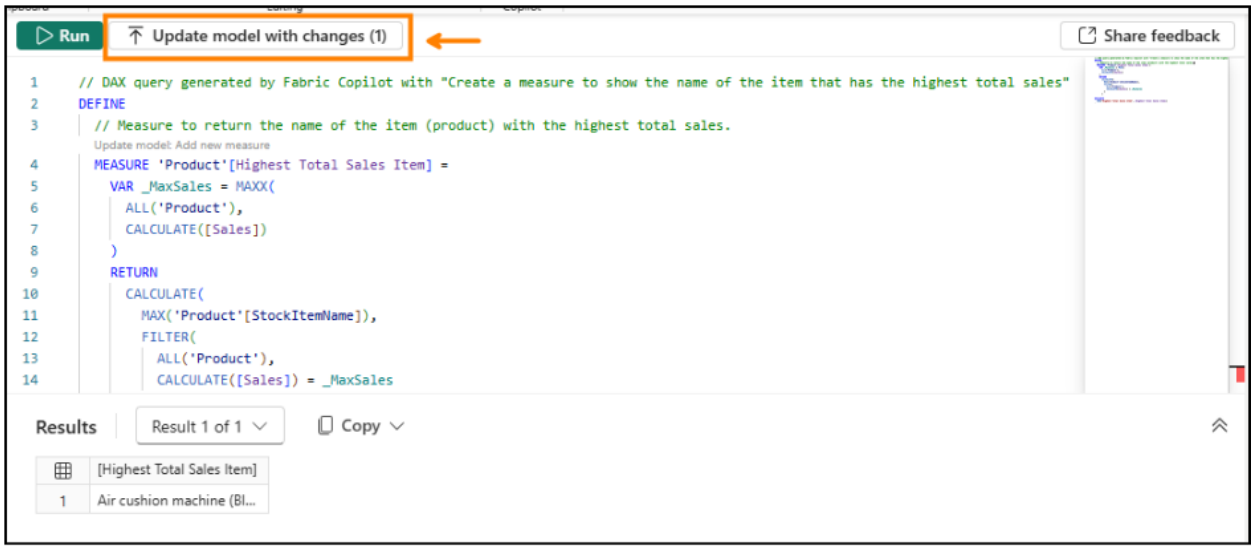

12. Type the following directions into the question box: **Create a measure to show the name of the item that has the highest total sales.** Click **Enter** or the arrow to the right of the question box.

13. Click **Run** to view the results.




14. Scroll down to find and click **Keep query**.

15. Click **Update model with changes**.




16. Practice using Copilot to create other measures using the same process. Start by clicking the **+** sign at the bottom left of your screen to create each new query. Here are some suggested prompts:

    a. Create a measure to show the name of the item that has the highest total dollar sales

    b. Create a measure to show the name of the item that has had the most *units* total sold

    c. Create a measure to show total sales of the item that sold the most total units

    d. Create a measure to show total sales of the item that sold the highest sales

e. Create a measure to show count of units sold of the item that sold the most units

f. Create a measure to show the count of units sold of the item that had the highest sales

g. Create a measure to show the unit price of the item with the most items sold

> **Important**
>
> It's important to run, test and thoroughly validate any queries that are generated with Copilot!

h. Create a measure to show the unit price of the item with the highest items sold

In this section, you discovered how to leverage Copilot in Power BI to create DAX measures. You can also use Copilot to better understand DAX by clicking the Copilot button and simply asking it to explain the DAX! Congratulations!

## Additional resources

Here are a few more resources that will help you with your next steps with Microsoft Fabric.

- Access all the information in the main Microsoft Fabric Documentation
- Explore Fabric through the Guided Tour
- Sign up for the Microsoft Fabric free trial
- Visit the Microsoft Fabric website
- Learn new skills by exploring the Fabric Learning modules
- Read the free e-book on getting started with Fabric
- Join the Fabric community to post your questions, share your feedback, and learn from others

Read the more in-depth Copilot-relevant technical documentation:

- Copilot for Power BI Overview - Power BI | Microsoft Learn
- Standalone Copilot Experience in Power BI (Preview) -- Power BI | Microsoft Learn
- Microsoft Fabric Copilot admin settings | Microsoft Learn

- Fabric data agent creation (preview) - Learn how to create a Fabric data agent | Microsoft Learn
- Best practices for configuring your data agent - Microsoft Fabric | Microsoft Learn
- Copilot for Microsoft Fabric and Power BI: FAQ - Microsoft Fabric | Microsoft Learn

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